

ENGLISH FOR RESTAURANT TEAMS

Restaurant Serving English

Clear orders. Confident service.

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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases

220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges

Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For restaurant servers, food runners, section leads, and guest-facing food-service teams.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight lessons on orders, menu choices, allergies, delays, corrections, payment, shared service, and section handovers. Three additional conversations cover availability, service charges, and accessible ordering.

01 Confirming seats and order details

4

Who asked for no onions? | Attach each dish and modifier to the correct guest, then read back the order before sending it.

02 Explaining menu choices and prices

13

The steak set or steak alone? | Explain a supplement, calculate comparable menu prices, and leave the purchase choice with the guest.

03 Receiving an allergy question

22

Checking the bun before ordering | Receive a reported allergy, ask the kitchen a precise question, and communicate unresolved ingredient and preparation information.

04 Coordinating courses and delays

31

Eight more minutes? | Explain a kitchen estimate against a guest departure time without converting readiness into a guaranteed meal completion.

05 Correcting a dish without blame

40

Pasta ordered, risotto delivered | Acknowledge an order mismatch, offer a specific remedy, and separate replacement timing from a bill-adjustment decision.

06 Explaining and splitting a bill

49

What does three ways mean? | Clarify equal payments versus item-based checks, state the arithmetic, and confirm the method before processing payment.

07 Agreeing on clearing and shared service

58

An empty plate still in use | Check permission to clear specific items and coordinate shared service without inferring that an empty plate is finished.

08 Handing over a live section

67

Two tables, two unfinished tasks | Give a concise table-by-table handover that separates meal stage, payment status, and an unresolved charge query.

Communication field notes

3

Three more workplace conversations

76

Answers and explanations

85

Fast-access phrase pages

104

Vocabulary index

106

Sources and publication notes

114

Warm service. Precise details.

Good service depends on listening closely while several things happen at once. Move between friendly guest-facing language and concise kitchen messages. Keep the table, seat, dish, request, timing, and responsible person clear.

Ask one useful question

A short clarification can prevent a long correction. Repeat the exact detail that is unclear and ask the guest to attach it to a person or dish. Do not turn an unidentified modifier into a table-wide instruction.

"Which dish should have no onions?"

Translate kitchen shorthand

Colleagues may say fire, covers, or on the fly. Guests need a clear explanation of their meal. Use internal shorthand only when the listener understands its local meaning.

"The kitchen estimates another eight minutes for your mains."

Show the complete comparison

A set price and an individual dish price are not interchangeable. Name what each includes before describing the difference. A supplement increases the stated base; it is not a replacement price.

"The steak set is \$29 with dessert; steak alone is \$27 without dessert."

Own the next step

An apology is more useful when followed by a specific action within your authority. Separate a replacement offer from an approved bill adjustment, and transfer live queries to a named colleague.

"I can offer the remake; the shift lead needs to review any bill adjustment."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All restaurants, prices, guests, and service events are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not food-safety certification, medical advice, or payment compliance. Follow current local law and actual allergy, food-handling, payment, and emergency procedures. Menu descriptions do not establish allergen safety. Do not delay urgent help for a routine service conversation.

Who asked for no onions?

A Read the situation

Attach each dish and modifier to the correct guest, then read back the order before sending it.

At fictional table 12, three guests are ordering. Seat one wants mushroom pasta; seat two wants salad with dressing separately; seat three has not chosen. Someone says "no onions," but server Lena cannot tell which dish the request belongs to. She has not sent the order. Guest Sam at seat two confirms that the onion request belongs to the salad. The dialogue follows Lena and section lead Cam checking that clarified request before transmission. Seat three still needs time. No allergy is reported in this case, and the onion request must not be treated as a confirmed allergy or a rule for every dish.

PEOPLE / Lena: Server | Cam: Section lead

CLARIFICATION IS PART OF ATTENTION

A guest may speak while another person is ordering, or answer on behalf of someone else. A brief, neutral check avoids blame and keeps the exchange moving. Say which detail needs clarification rather than asking the whole table to repeat everything.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which seat has not chosen?

A Seat two

B All three seats

C Seat three

D Seat one

2. Which request already belongs to the salad?

A Dressing mixed through the salad

B Dressing separately

C No mushrooms in the pasta

D A completed third main

3. What did Lena need to clarify when she first heard the request?

A Which dish should have dressing mixed in

B Whether seat three had ordered pasta

C Whether seat one wanted a different main

D Which dish should have no onions

Answers and explanations: [page 85](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

cover

One diner counted for restaurant service or planning.

IN USE serve three covers

seat number

Identifier linking an order to a place at a table.

IN USE confirm the seat number

table number

Identifier used to locate a dining table.

IN USE check the table number

order pad

Written surface used to record guest orders.

IN USE update the order pad

point of sale

System for entering orders and recording sales, often abbreviated POS.

IN USE enter the order at the point of sale

order ticket

Record of dishes and instructions sent for preparation.

IN USE read the order ticket

modifier

Instruction changing an item from its standard preparation or presentation.

IN USE attach a modifier

omission

Requested removal of an ingredient or component.

IN USE confirm the omission

substitution

Replacement of one component with another when available and permitted.

IN USE check a substitution

on the side

Served separately rather than mixed into or placed on the dish.

IN USE serve dressing on the side

read-back

Spoken repetition of recorded details to check accuracy.

IN USE give a read-back

seat reference

Link showing which guest a detail concerns.

IN USE clarify the seat reference

Precision check

No onions needs a clear dish reference. Do not attach it to every plate because the speaker was unclear. A modifier describes the requested change; a reported allergy requires its own accurate communication and the actual allergy process.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

course

Stage of a meal, such as a starter or main.

IN USE enter the main course

main

Principal dish in a meal.

IN USE choose a main

starter

Dish served before the main course in the relevant menu format.

IN USE order a starter

garnish

Item added to finish or accompany a dish.

IN USE identify the garnish

accompaniment

Food served alongside a principal item.

IN USE describe the accompaniment

preparation request

Guest instruction about how an item should be prepared.

IN USE confirm the preparation request

dietary requirement

Food-related need that must be described accurately and handled appropriately.

IN USE clarify a dietary requirement

preference

Stated choice that must not automatically be labeled a medical condition.

IN USE record a preference

pending choice

Selection that has not yet been made.

IN USE keep a choice pending

send the order

Transmit a confirmed order through the restaurant's system.

IN USE send the order

order sequence

Agreed order in which information or dishes are handled.

IN USE preserve the order sequence

confirmation

Explicit agreement that repeated details are correct.

IN USE obtain confirmation

Precision check

Seat three has not chosen is not the same as seat three is not eating. Confirmed items and pending choices can coexist. Follow the restaurant process for sending partial orders, but never invent a third dish to complete a ticket.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CLARIFY THE DISH

"Which dish should have no onions?"

READ BACK SEAT ONE

"Seat one is the mushroom pasta."

PRESERVE THE PENDING CHOICE

"Seat three is still deciding."

AVOID A TABLE-WIDE CHANGE

"I will not apply that request to the other dishes."

CHECK THE GUEST

"Is that request for your salad?"

READ BACK SEAT TWO

"Seat two is the salad with dressing on the side."

ATTACH THE MODIFIER

"I have noted no onions for your salad."

ASK BRIEFLY

"May I check one detail before I send this?"

Which dish

Targets the missing reference instead of questioning the guest's reason.

Still deciding

Describes an unfinished choice without canceling the meal.

On the side

Common serving phrase meaning separately.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

TRANSLATE SEPARATELY

"You would like the dressing served separately, correct?"

KEEP THE RECORD ALIGNED

"The seat reference and modifier need to stay together."

CONFIRM UNDERSTANDING

"Have I matched the dishes and requests correctly?"

KEEP TRANSMISSION ACCURATE

"The order has not been sent yet."

SEPARATE REQUEST AND GUARANTEE

"I will confirm any preparation question through our kitchen process."

AVOID AN INVENTED ALLERGY

"No allergy has been reported in this exchange."

ALLOW TIME

"I will give seat three another moment to choose."

CLOSE WITH THE CORRECTED DETAIL

"Salad for seat two, no onions, dressing on the side."

Put on the request

Refers to recording the instruction, not adding onions to the food.

Yet

Distinguishes an unsent order from one already in preparation.

Matched correctly

Invites correction before an avoidable error moves to the kitchen.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which clarification is most useful?

- A** Which dish should have no onions?
- B** Shall I put no onions on the whole table?
- C** Is the pasta the one with both changes?
- D** Should I send three portions of pasta?

2. What should be sent as the salad modifier after Sam confirms?

- A** No mushrooms in every dish
- B** Dressing mixed through all dishes
- C** Cancel seat three's meal
- D** No onions, dressing on the side

3. Which statement preserves the pending choice?

- A** Seat three ordered mushroom pasta.
- B** Seat three is not eating.
- C** All three mains are confirmed.
- D** Seat three is still deciding.

4. What does the onion request establish medically?

- A** No allergy diagnosis or report by itself
- B** A confirmed onion allergy for all diners
- C** That no allergy process is ever needed
- D** That all foods are safe

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

Who asked for no onions?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

seat reference / confirmation / send the order / pending choice / covers / omission / read-back / on the side / modifier / order ticket

- 01 **Lena:** Cam, can you check table twelve with me before I send it? Three guests, two mains chosen. I clarified the onion request with Sam at seat two.
- 02 **Cam:** Yes. Which dish gets the ¹ _____? Your first note says no onions between the two mains, so I cannot tell which one it follows.
- 03 **Lena:** It belongs to the salad, not the pasta. Sam also wants the dressing separately. I have corrected the note against seat two.
- 04 **Cam:** Salad, no onions, dressing ² _____. That is clear. What is seat one having?
- 05 **Lena:** Mushroom pasta, unchanged. Seat three was still looking at the menu when I came over, so I have left that choice open.
- 06 **Cam:** Keep it as a ³ _____, then. Do not copy the pasta into the third seat just to fill the space.
- 07 **Lena:** I will go back to that guest. Before I do, can you repeat what you have? I want to catch any mismatch now.
- 08 **Cam:** Here is the ⁴ _____: table twelve, seat one mushroom pasta; seat two salad, no onions, dressing on the side; seat three still deciding.
- 09 **Lena:** Correct. The salad has both requests. I originally wrote them between the items because two people were speaking at once.
- 10 **Cam:** Now the ⁵ _____ makes the connection clear. Keep the requests attached to that item in the system too.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Lena:** I have not sent anything yet. I wanted to settle the unclear detail first rather than ask the kitchen to interpret my note.
- 12 **Cam:** Good. The ⁶ _____ needs the same dish-and-seat links. A general no-onions note across the table would give the kitchen a different instruction.
- 13 **Lena:** The screen shows three diners, but only two main dishes so far. That is why the totals do not match yet.
- 14 **Cam:** Three ⁷ _____, two confirmed mains. That is fine while the last person is choosing. The diner count does not supply a missing order.
- 15 **Lena:** Sam said no onions, but did not report an allergy. I repeated the request and confirmed the dish rather than guessing the reason.
- 16 **Cam:** Record the ⁸ _____ accurately. If an allergy is reported, use our allergy procedure; do not treat an ordinary modifier as a substitute for that process.
- 17 **Lena:** I will return to seat three now and ask what they would like. Then I can repeat the complete order to the table.
- 18 **Cam:** Get that last ⁹ _____ from the guest. Leave Sam's salad request as it is unless Sam changes it.
- 19 **Lena:** Understood: pasta unchanged, salad with its two requests, third main still open. I will come back if the guest needs a kitchen check.
- 20 **Cam:** All right. Follow our process when you ¹⁰ _____. Keep the dish, seat, and instructions together so the kitchen receives what the guests actually asked for.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. modifier | 2. on the side | 3. pending choice | 4. read-back | 5. seat reference | 6. order ticket | 7. covers | 8. omission | 9. confirmation | 10. send the order

Attach a different request

F Say it

Table 8 has two covers. Seat one orders tomato soup; seat two orders grilled fish. A lemon-separately request is clarified as belonging to the fish. No third diner or allergy is reported.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

covers / two / fish / unchanged

Server: "The lemon request belongs to the ¹ _____."

Guest: "That is seat ² _____."

Server: "The tomato soup remains ³ _____."

Guest: "There are two ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. fish | 2. two | 3. unchanged | 4. covers

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the cloze answers. Read Lena and Cam's exchange, stressing table twelve, seat one, seat two, and seat three.
2. Switch roles. Say the final read-back without changing the pasta or inventing the third main.
3. Complete the table 8 transfer and check its key. Repeat with a partner: fish, seat two, soup unchanged, two covers.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The steak set or steak alone?

A Read the situation

Explain a supplement, calculate comparable menu prices, and leave the purchase choice with the guest.

The fictional lunch set is \$24 and includes a main and dessert. Choosing steak adds a \$5 supplement to that set price. The a la carte steak is \$27 without dessert. Both steak options include potatoes. Guest Jordan initially thinks the steak set must cost \$24, then wonders whether potatoes cost extra. Server Priya must compare the \$29 steak set with the \$27 steak alone, explain the two-dollar difference, and avoid inventing a separate dessert price, drink inclusion, or tax policy. No choice has been made at the start.

PEOPLE / Jordan: Lunch guest | Priya: Server

HELP THE GUEST COMPARE

A recommendation should explain a relevant difference without pressuring the guest or implying a more expensive option is always better. State the total for each option and its inclusions. Let the guest decide whether the added item is worth the difference.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the steak set price?

A \$24

B \$27

C \$32

D \$29

2. Which item is included in both steak options?

A A separate starter

B Potatoes

C Dessert

D Coffee

3. What is not supplied?

A The set base price

B The steak supplement

C The a la carte steak price

D A separate dessert price

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

set menu

Group of included courses offered for a stated price, subject to listed conditions.

IN USE explain the set menu

a la carte

Ordered as individual menu items rather than as a set.

IN USE order a la carte

supplement

Additional charge added to a stated base price.

IN USE apply the steak supplement

base price

Starting price before specified additions.

IN USE state the base price

inclusive price

Price covering the items or charges explicitly named as included.

IN USE explain the inclusive price

inclusion

Item or service covered by the quoted option.

IN USE compare the inclusions

exclusion

Item or charge not covered by an option.

IN USE clarify an exclusion

price difference

Amount separating two prices on a comparable basis.

IN USE calculate the price difference

standalone price

Price charged for an item bought separately.

IN USE verify the standalone price

upgrade

Change to a different or enhanced option, often at an added cost.

IN USE explain the upgrade

main-and-dessert set

Meal option combining a main course and dessert.

IN USE choose the main-and-dessert set

side dish

Food served alongside a principal dish.

IN USE include a side dish

Precision check

The \$5 supplement belongs to the \$24 set base: $\$24 + \$5 = \$29$. It is not added to the \$27 a la carte price. The comparison is \$29 with dessert versus \$27 without dessert, with potatoes in both.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

portion

Amount served to one person or as specified.

IN USE describe the portion

menu description

Written account of a dish or offer.

IN USE read the menu description

daily special

Dish or offer identified as special for the relevant service period.

IN USE explain the daily special

availability

Whether an item can currently be ordered.

IN USE check availability

value comparison

Assessment of price alongside the contents or benefits of an option.

IN USE make a value comparison

additional charge

Amount payable beyond a specified quoted price.

IN USE identify an additional charge

price clarification

Explanation resolving uncertainty about what an amount means.

IN USE give a price clarification

itemized total

Sum showing the individual components that make up the charge.

IN USE present an itemized total

optional extra

Additional item that is not compulsory or automatically included.

IN USE describe an optional extra

menu pairing

Combination of items offered or suggested together.

IN USE explain the menu pairing

price basis

Items and conditions to which a quoted price applies.

IN USE state the price basis

guest choice

Selection made by the diner after receiving relevant information.

IN USE confirm the guest choice

Precision check

A two-dollar difference between these options does not establish that every dessert costs two dollars separately. Do not promise identical portions, included drinks, or an all-in bill total when those details are absent. Explain the menu prices actually supplied.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

INTRODUCE THE SET

"The lunch set includes a main and dessert."

EXPLAIN THE ADDITION

"Steak carries a \$5 supplement on that set."

INTRODUCE THE ALTERNATIVE

"The a la carte steak is \$27."

KEEP SHARED INCLUSIONS CLEAR

"Both steak options include potatoes."

STATE THE BASE

"The set starts at \$24."

GIVE THE COMBINED PRICE

"That makes the steak set \$29."

NAME THE DIFFERENCE IN CONTENTS

"The a la carte option does not include dessert."

CALCULATE THE DIFFERENCE

"The set is two dollars more than steak alone."

Starts at

Signals a base price that may change with a specified selection.

Carries a supplement

Common menu language for an added charge.

That makes

Introduces the result of a transparent calculation.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID AN UNSUPPORTED STANDALONE PRICE

"That difference is not a quoted separate dessert price."

DO NOT INVENT A SURCHARGE

"No extra potato charge is listed in these options."

AVOID PRESSURE

"It depends on whether you want the included dessert."

CONFIRM THE CHOSEN OPTION

"Let me confirm which option you would like."

RESPOND TO A PRICE MISUNDERSTANDING

"The \$24 is the base, before the steak supplement."

KEEP THE CHOICE OPEN

"Would you prefer the set with dessert or the steak alone?"

SEPARATE UNKNOWN DETAILS

"I would need to check any detail not stated on this menu."

SUMMARIZE EVENLY

"\$29 with dessert, or \$27 without dessert; potatoes are included in both."

Both

Prevents a shared inclusion from sounding exclusive to one option.

Two dollars more

Compares these options without assigning every component a standalone price.

Would you prefer

Gives the decision to the guest after the comparison.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which calculation is correct?

- A** $\$27 - \$24 = \$3$ for dessert
- B** $\$24 + \$5 = \$29$ for the steak set
- C** $\$27 + \$5 = \$32$ for the steak set
- D** $\$24 - \$5 = \$19$ for the steak set

2. Which comparison is complete?

- A** \$24 versus \$27 with identical inclusions
- B** \$29 without potatoes versus \$27 with potatoes
- C** \$5 versus \$27 for the entire meal
- D** \$29 with dessert versus \$27 without dessert; both include potatoes.

3. What cannot be inferred from the two-dollar difference?

- A** Both steak options include potatoes.
- B** The restaurant's standalone dessert price is \$2.
- C** The steak set costs \$2 more.
- D** The set includes dessert.

4. Which recommendation avoids pressure?

- A** The set includes coffee as well as dessert.
- B** If you want dessert, the set includes it for two dollars more than steak alone.
- C** The set saves five dollars compared with steak alone.
- D** You can add any dessert later for two dollars.

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The steak set or steak alone?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

main-and-dessert set / guest choice / supplement / price basis / price difference / base price / standalone price / inclusion / value comparison / a la carte

- 01 **Jordan:** Could you help me with the lunch menu? I saw twenty-four dollars beside the set, but there is another amount beside the steak.
- 02 **Priya:** Certainly. Twenty-four dollars is the ¹ _____ for a main and dessert. Choosing steak adds five dollars, so that particular set comes to twenty-nine.
- 03 **Jordan:** So the steak is five dollars extra on the set? I first read that as a separate price, which did not seem right.
- 04 **Priya:** Exactly. It is a ² _____ to the set. Twenty-four plus five is twenty-nine for the steak set, including dessert.
- 05 **Jordan:** I also see steak listed separately at twenty-seven. Is that another way of ordering the same main without taking the lunch set?
- 06 **Priya:** Yes, that is the ³ _____ option. The steak is twenty-seven without dessert. Both options include potatoes, so you do not need to add them to this comparison.
- 07 **Jordan:** Good, I was about to ask about the potatoes. I do not want to discover I need to order a side as well.
- 08 **Priya:** Potatoes are a shared ⁴ _____ here. The difference stated on this menu is the dessert, alongside the two different menu prices.
- 09 **Jordan:** Then the set is two dollars more than the steak alone. I am not especially hungry, so I am deciding whether I want dessert.
- 10 **Priya:** That is the correct ⁵ _____. If you want the included dessert, the set is twenty-nine. If not, the steak alone is twenty-seven.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Jordan:** Could I order the steak alone and add dessert for two dollars later, or does that price only work with the set?
- 12 **Priya:** I would need to check the ⁶ _____ before quoting that. The two-dollar comparison does not mean every separately ordered dessert has a two-dollar price.
- 13 **Jordan:** That makes sense. I may not want dessert after the steak. Could you give me a moment to choose?
- 14 **Priya:** Of course. A useful ⁷ _____ depends on what you want to eat. The more expensive option is not automatically the better choice for you.
- 15 **Jordan:** Is coffee included with the dessert in that set? I sometimes see that elsewhere, but I cannot find it in this description.
- 16 **Priya:** Coffee is not part of the stated ⁸ _____ in the details we are comparing. I would check its price and status separately rather than tell you it is part of the set.
- 17 **Jordan:** Thanks. I will leave coffee for now. Could you repeat just the two steak prices for me?
- 18 **Priya:** Then the ⁹ _____ is twenty-nine for steak, potatoes, and the included dessert, or twenty-seven for steak and potatoes without dessert.
- 19 **Jordan:** Let me check with my friend about dessert before I decide. I have not chosen the set yet.
- 20 **Priya:** Certainly. I will wait for your ¹⁰ _____. When you are ready, tell me set or a la carte, and I will confirm the option before entering it.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. base price | 2. supplement | 3. a la carte | 4. inclusion | 5. price difference | 6. standalone price | 7. value comparison | 8. main-and-dessert set | 9. price basis | 10. guest choice

Compare another set

F Say it

A fictional main-and-dessert set has a \$20 base and a \$4 fish supplement. Fish alone costs \$22 without dessert. Both options include rice. No separate dessert price is supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

rice / twenty-two / unspecified / twenty-four

Server: "The fish set costs ¹ _____ dollars."

Guest: "Fish alone is ² _____ dollars."

Server: "Both options include ³ _____."

Guest: "The separate dessert price is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. twenty-four | 2. twenty-two | 3. rice | 4. unspecified

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the answers, then read the menu exchange with a partner. Stress twenty-four plus five and twenty-nine versus twenty-seven.
2. Switch roles. Repeat the final comparison, keeping potatoes in both options and dessert in the set only.
3. Complete and check the fish-set transfer. Read both prices aloud; do not turn the bundle difference into a standalone dessert price.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Checking the bun before ordering

A Read the situation

03

Receive a reported allergy, ask the kitchen a precise question, and communicate unresolved ingredient and preparation information.

At table 6, guest Eli reports a sesame allergy and asks whether the burger bun is suitable. Server Noor has an old menu description, not current ingredient or cross-contact information. Kitchen lead Cam is available to discuss the question before any order is sent. The conversation does not supply a verified bun ingredient list, a confirmed preparation arrangement, or a safe alternative. Noor must preserve the reported allergen, check the current product and handling information through the real allergy procedure, and avoid replacing an unanswered question with reassurance.

PEOPLE / Eli: Guest reporting a sesame allergy | Noor: Server

TAKE THE DISCLOSURE SERIOUSLY

Thank the guest for identifying the allergy and make the next step clear. Do not test whether the guest sounds serious enough or rely on how a product looks. The guest should hear what is known, what needs checking, and who is handling the question.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which allergen does Eli report?

- A** An unspecified dislike
- B** A confirmed milk allergy
- C** A general dislike of bread
- D** Sesame

2. What information does Noor hold?

- A** An old menu description
- B** A verified current bun specification
- C** A confirmed cross-contact assessment
- D** A guaranteed safe alternative

3. Who is available before an order is sent?

- A** Only a future supplier next month
- B** No responsible colleague
- C** Another diner making a guess
- D** Kitchen lead Cam

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

food allergy

Immune-system reaction to a food protein that can be serious.

IN USE report a food allergy

allergen

Substance capable of causing an allergic reaction in a susceptible person.

IN USE identify the allergen

sesame

Seed recognized among the major food allergens in the United States.

IN USE flag a sesame allergy

ingredient list

Record of substances intentionally used in a product.

IN USE check the current ingredient list

product specification

Detailed information describing a particular supplied food product.

IN USE verify the product specification

supplier label

Label information attached to or associated with a supplied product.

IN USE inspect the supplier label

recipe

Specified ingredients and method for making a dish.

IN USE check the current recipe

cross-contact

Unintended introduction of an allergen into another food.

IN USE assess allergen cross-contact

shared equipment

Equipment used for more than one food or preparation.

IN USE check shared equipment

preparation area

Place where food is handled or assembled.

IN USE verify the preparation area

allergen matrix

Structured record showing allergen information across relevant menu items.

IN USE consult the current allergen matrix

current product

Actual product presently used, which may differ from an older description.

IN USE identify the current product

Precision check

A plain-looking bun is not an ingredient list. Ingredient information and cross-contact information answer related but different questions. Removing visible seeds does not establish suitability. An old menu description cannot certify the actual product being prepared today.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

recipe change

Alteration to a dish's ingredients or method.

IN USE verify a recipe change

product substitution

Use of a different supplied item in place of the usual one.

IN USE check for a product substitution

allergy flag

Clear system marker identifying a reported allergy for the relevant order.

IN USE enter an allergy flag

kitchen lead

Responsible kitchen colleague coordinating the relevant preparation question.

IN USE consult the kitchen lead

order hold

Pause before progressing an order while a necessary matter is resolved.

IN USE maintain the order hold

ingredient verification

Check of the ingredients in the actual relevant product.

IN USE complete ingredient verification

handling information

Details about how food is stored, prepared, and served.

IN USE obtain handling information

unsupported assurance

Reassuring claim without adequate information or authority.

IN USE avoid an unsupported assurance

reported allergen

Substance the guest identifies as the source of an allergy.

IN USE repeat the reported allergen

alternative dish

Different menu item that still requires appropriate checks for the guest.

IN USE check an alternative dish

allergic reaction

Response to an allergen that may require urgent medical attention.

IN USE follow allergic-reaction procedures

emergency response

Immediate action through the applicable emergency arrangements.

IN USE activate the emergency response

Precision check

No reaction or exposure occurs in this scenario. Do not invent treatment instructions or tell a guest to test the food. Actual symptoms or urgent concerns require the appropriate emergency response, not completion of a routine menu inquiry.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

ACKNOWLEDGE THE DISCLOSURE

"Thank you for telling me about the sesame allergy."

REPEAT THE ALLERGEN

"I have heard sesame; is that correct?"

STATE THE INFORMATION LIMIT

"This old description does not verify today's bun."

PAUSE THE ORDER

"I will check before sending an order."

NAME THE NEXT PERSON

"I will speak with Cam, our kitchen lead."

ASK ABOUT THE ACTUAL PRODUCT

"Which bun is being used for this service?"

ASK ABOUT THE RECORD

"Can you verify its current ingredient information?"

INCLUDE HANDLING

"We also need the relevant cross-contact information."

Thank you for telling me

Receives the information without questioning the guest's credibility.

Today's bun

Directs the check to the actual product, not an outdated menu.

Before sending

Places verification ahead of order transmission.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

AVOID APPEARANCE-BASED REASSURANCE

"A plain surface does not establish the ingredients."

KEEP THE GUEST INFORMED

"The question is still being checked."

PRESERVE THE ALLERGY FLAG

"The reported sesame allergy must stay linked to your order."

AVOID UNSUPPORTED CERTAINTY

"I cannot confirm suitability from the information available."

DO NOT IMPROVISE A FIX

"Removing visible seeds would not answer the safety question."

AVOID A FALSE ALTERNATIVE

"A different dish would need its own appropriate checks."

SEPARATE RECEIPT AND RESOLUTION

"Cam has received the question; it is not resolved yet."

RETURN TO THE GUEST ACCURATELY

"I will explain the verified information and any remaining limits before you choose."

Also

Makes clear that handling is an additional issue, not answered by ingredients alone.

Still being checked

Gives an honest interim status.

Cannot confirm

Marks an information limit without inventing a safe or unsafe verdict.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which first response is best?

- A** Try a small bite first.
- B** Thank you for telling me; I will check the current bun and handling information with Cam.
- C** The bun looks plain, so it is safe.
- D** Pick off any visible seeds.

2. Which distinction matters?

- A** Receiving a question automatically resolves it.
- B** Ingredients and cross-contact are separate questions.
- C** A plain appearance proves no sesame.
- D** An old menu is always current.

3. What does Cam's availability establish?

- A** A kitchen lead can discuss the query.
- B** The bun has been certified suitable.
- C** No allergy flag is needed.
- D** A different dish is automatically safe.

4. Which guest update is accurate?

- A** Every dish is safe for every allergy.
- B** The old description is enough.
- C** A reaction has occurred even though none is reported.
- D** I cannot confirm suitability yet; the current information is being checked.

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

Checking the bun before ordering

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

order hold / product specification / ingredient verification / cross-contact / reported allergen / allergy flag / ingredient list / handling information / alternative dish / current product

- 01 **Eli:** Before I order, I need to ask about the burger bun. I have a sesame allergy, and the picture does not tell me what is in the bread.
- 02 **Noor:** Thank you for telling me. I will repeat the ¹ _____ when I speak with the kitchen: sesame. Is that correct, and is the bun the item you want me to check?
- 03 **Eli:** Yes, sesame, and I am asking about the bun first. I know some bread can contain it even without seeds on the surface.
- 04 **Noor:** I have only an old description here, not verified information for the ² _____. I will check with Cam, our kitchen lead, before sending an order.
- 05 **Eli:** Please include how it is handled, not just the ingredients. I would rather wait for an accurate answer than have someone tell me it is probably fine.
- 06 **Noor:** Of course. I will ask about the ingredients and ³ _____. I cannot confirm suitability from this description, and I will not put the order through while that question is unresolved.
- 07 **Eli:** Have you been able to pass that question to Cam? I would like to know it has reached the person checking the kitchen information.
- 08 **Noor:** Yes, Cam has received it. We need the current ⁴ _____ for today's bun. That check has not been completed, so the old description is not our answer.
- 09 **Eli:** Good. Please ask about preparation as well. I have had to be careful with shared equipment at other restaurants.
- 10 **Noor:** Yes. The relevant ⁵ _____ still needs verification through our allergy procedure. I made clear that you are asking about both ingredients and preparation.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Eli:** Thank you. I also do not want anyone to remove visible seeds and assume that has answered the question. The bread itself matters.
- 12 **Noor:** Agreed. We need the actual ⁶ _____ and relevant supplier information. A plain surface or removal of visible seeds is not enough to establish suitability.
- 13 **Eli:** I will wait. Please do not bring me a different dish in the meantime; I need to choose after the check.
- 14 **Noor:** Understood. The ⁷ _____ remains in place. Any alternative would need its own appropriate checks and your agreement before we proceed.
- 15 **Eli:** Has the kitchen actually checked the bun yet, or are they still finding the information?
- 16 **Noor:** Certainly. The ⁸ _____ and preparation checks are not complete yet. I will keep their actual status clear rather than describe Cam receiving the question as a final answer.
- 17 **Eli:** If the bun does not work for me, could we discuss another option afterward? I have not picked one yet.
- 18 **Noor:** I will not. Any ⁹ _____ would need its own checks and your choice. Your order has not been sent.
- 19 **Eli:** That is fine. I will wait for the verified information before deciding. Please keep the sesame allergy attached to the discussion if someone else takes over.
- 20 **Noor:** Yes. The ¹⁰ _____ and the unresolved question must stay together. I will return with the information we can actually confirm and explain any remaining limits.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. reported allergen | 2. current product | 3. cross-contact | 4. ingredient list | 5. handling information | 6. product specification | 7. order hold | 8. ingredient verification | 9. alternative dish | 10. allergy flag

Receive a different allergen question

F Say it

03

At table 9, guest Alex reports a peanut allergy and asks about a sauce. The server has an old description only. Kitchen lead Imani accepts the query. No ingredient or handling answer is yet verified.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Imani / peanut / sauce / confirmed

Server: "The reported allergen is ¹ _____."

Colleague: "The product being questioned is the ² _____."

Server: "The receiving kitchen lead is ³ _____."

Colleague: "Suitability is not yet ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. peanut | 2. sauce | 3. Imani | 4. confirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the cloze answers. Read the conversation, keeping sesame clear in every handoff and update.
2. Switch roles. Stress the difference between Cam receiving the question and completing the ingredient and handling checks.
3. Complete the peanut-sauce transfer and check the key. Repeat all four lines without claiming the sauce is suitable.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Eight more minutes?

A Read the situation

04

Explain a kitchen estimate against a guest departure time without converting readiness into a guaranteed meal completion.

Table 14 has finished its starters. The mains were fired at 7:20. At 7:30, the kitchen estimates another eight minutes because one dish is still being prepared. The guests need to leave at 7:50. Server Tomas must explain the current estimate and offer a discussion about timing, while avoiding a promise that the mains will arrive exactly at 7:38 or that the guests can finish comfortably before departure. No cancellation, faster substitute, priority slot, or price adjustment has been approved in this case.

PEOPLE / Tomas: Server | Riley: Guest at table 14

TELL THE GUEST WHAT THE CLOCK ACTUALLY MEANS

Internal timing can sound like a promise when repeated without context. Translate preparation status into guest-facing language, acknowledge the departure constraint, and check realistic options. Do not hide uncertainty behind kitchen jargon or assume the guest has enough time to eat.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. When were the mains fired?

A 7:30

B 7:38 as a completed event

C 7:50

D 7:20

2. What is the current estimate at 7:30?

A Guaranteed departure at 7:38

B Another eight minutes

C Eight minutes total since 7:20

D Guaranteed service at 7:30

3. What is the guests' departure requirement?

A Arrive at 7:50

B Have the mains ready by 7:50

C Leave at 7:50

D Begin starters at 7:50

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

fire

Kitchen instruction to begin or advance preparation at the required service stage.

IN USE fire the mains

fired time

Recorded time when the relevant preparation instruction was given.

IN USE confirm the fired time

pickup

Kitchen-to-service handoff when dishes are ready for collection.

IN USE coordinate pickup

pass

Kitchen area where finished dishes are checked and handed to service staff.

IN USE collect from the pass

expeditor

Person coordinating dish completion and kitchen-to-floor delivery.

IN USE check with the expeditor

course pacing

Timing of successive stages of a meal.

IN USE adjust course pacing

ticket time

Elapsed time associated with an order ticket, measured from a specified event.

IN USE check the ticket time

readiness estimate

Approximate expectation for when food will be ready at the stated stage.

IN USE give a readiness estimate

remaining time

Additional duration expected from the current update.

IN USE state the remaining time

departure deadline

Latest time by which guests need to leave.

IN USE acknowledge the departure deadline

service window

Period available for serving or completing a specified service activity.

IN USE discuss the service window

preparation stage

Current step in making a dish.

IN USE confirm the preparation stage

Precision check

Eight more minutes at 7:30 points to approximately 7:38 for the stated readiness estimate. It is not eight minutes from 7:20. Readiness, delivery to the table, eating, payment, and departure are separate events.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

table update

Information given to guests about their order or service.

IN USE deliver a table update

timing constraint

Limit that affects when something needs to occur.

IN USE clarify the timing constraint

bottleneck

Step limiting the progress of the overall process.

IN USE identify the bottleneck

coordinated service

Arrangement for related dishes to reach guests in a planned sequence.

IN USE arrange coordinated service

rush request

Request to accelerate work that still requires confirmation.

IN USE check a rush request

priority

Relative precedence given to a task under the actual service arrangement.

IN USE confirm priority

on the fly

Urgent preparation request in restaurant shorthand, not a guarantee of instant service.

IN USE request a dish on the fly

elapsed time

Duration already passed between specified points.

IN USE calculate elapsed time

update point

Agreed occasion for communicating the next status.

IN USE agree an update point

timing discussion

Conversation about feasible options under a time constraint.

IN USE offer a timing discussion

completion promise

Commitment that a stated outcome will occur by a defined time.

IN USE avoid an unsupported completion promise

contingency

Alternative arrangement available if the intended plan cannot work.

IN USE verify a contingency

Precision check

The twelve minutes between 7:38 and 7:50 is a clock difference, not proof of a comfortable meal. Confirm what the kitchen estimate covers and discuss actual options. Do not promise an accelerated dish or cancellation before the appropriate decision is made.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE WAIT

"I am sorry your mains are taking longer than you expected."

NAME THE REMAINING WORK

"One dish is still being prepared."

PRESERVE THE SOURCE

"This is the kitchen's current estimate."

AVOID A FALSE COMFORT CLAIM

"I cannot promise that leaves enough time for your meal."

GIVE THE CURRENT UPDATE

"At 7:30, the kitchen estimates another eight minutes."

TRANSLATE THE ESTIMATE

"That points to around 7:38, not a guaranteed service time."

REPEAT THE CONSTRAINT

"You need to leave at 7:50."

SEPARATE STAGES

"Kitchen readiness and arrival at the table are different stages."

Another

Marks additional time from the current update.

Around

Signals approximation rather than a fixed appointment.

Current estimate

Allows for a changed status without pretending certainty.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

OFFER A DISCUSSION

"Let me discuss the timing options with you and the kitchen."

CLARIFY THE CLOCK

"The eight minutes is from the 7:30 update."

DO NOT PROMISE A SUBSTITUTE

"Any alternative timing needs to be checked."

DO NOT DISMISS THE DEADLINE

"Your departure time matters to the decision."

AVOID INVENTED PRIORITY

"I cannot promise a faster slot before it is confirmed."

KEEP THE EARLIER TIME CLEAR

"The mains were fired at 7:20."

AGREE THE NEXT COMMUNICATION

"Let us agree when you will receive the next update."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"The estimate is still provisional, and the timing options need discussion."

Need to leave

Identifies a departure constraint, not a food-readiness target.

Before it is confirmed

Keeps a request distinct from an accepted commitment.

Enough time

Requires the guest's practical needs, not arithmetic alone.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which timing explanation is accurate?

- A** The guests can definitely finish by 7:50.
- B** At 7:30 the kitchen estimates eight more minutes, pointing to around 7:38.
- C** The mains were served at 7:20.
- D** Eight minutes from 7:20 guarantees service at 7:28.

2. What does 7:50 minus 7:38 establish?

- A** A promise that payment is complete
- B** A confirmed twelve-minute cooking time
- C** That the guests can stay indefinitely
- D** A twelve-minute clock interval, not guaranteed dining time

3. Which offer stays within the facts?

- A** I can discuss the timing options with you and the kitchen.
- B** I guarantee a replacement in two minutes.
- C** The bill is already canceled.
- D** Your table has automatically received top priority.

4. Which phrase needs translation for a guest?

- A** The current estimate is eight more minutes.
- B** Your mains were fired at 7:20.
- C** You need to leave at 7:50.
- D** One dish is still being prepared.

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

Eight more minutes?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

rush request / table update / completion promise / timing discussion / readiness estimate / departure deadline / fired time / Pickup / remaining time / timing constraint

- 01 **Riley:** Could you check our mains, please? We have finished the starters, and we need to leave at seven fifty. I am beginning to worry about the time.
- 02 **Tomas:** I am sorry about the wait. I have a current ¹ _____ from the kitchen: at seven thirty, they expect another eight minutes. One dish is still being prepared.
- 03 **Riley:** Another eight minutes from now? I thought the mains had gone in earlier. I am trying to work out whether we can stay.
- 04 **Tomas:** The ² _____ is from the seven-thirty update. That points to around seven thirty-eight for the stated estimate, but I cannot guarantee arrival at that exact time.
- 05 **Riley:** When did they start preparing them? We are not upset with you, but we do need to know where we stand.
- 06 **Tomas:** The ³ _____ was seven twenty. In our kitchen language, that is when the mains were called for preparation. It does not mean they were ready or served then.
- 07 **Riley:** All right. If they are ready around seven thirty-eight, that leaves twelve minutes before we have to go. That sounds rather tight for us.
- 08 **Tomas:** I agree that your ⁴ _____ matters. The twelve minutes is only the difference between those times; it does not guarantee enough time to receive the food, eat, and settle the bill.
- 09 **Riley:** Can you move our order ahead of everyone else? I realize the kitchen is busy, but we cannot miss the event we are going to.
- 10 **Tomas:** I can discuss a ⁵ _____ with the kitchen. I cannot promise a different position or faster completion before they confirm what is actually possible.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Riley:** Would it be quicker to change one of the dishes? I do not want to cancel the whole meal if a realistic option is available.
- 12 **Tomas:** We can have a ⁶ _____ about that. I would need the kitchen to check any alternative; I do not have a confirmed substitute time to offer you now.
- 13 **Riley:** Please check. We would rather hear what is possible now than sit here hoping the food will arrive.
- 14 **Tomas:** Understood. My next ⁷ _____ should tell you what the kitchen can confirm and what remains uncertain. We should also agree when you will hear from me again.
- 15 **Riley:** Does that time mean ready in the kitchen or actually at our table? We will still need time to eat and pay.
- 16 **Tomas:** Correct. ⁸ _____ and delivery to the table are separate from the cooking estimate. I will clarify which stage the estimate covers when I speak with the kitchen.
- 17 **Riley:** Thank you. We still need to leave at seven fifty, even if the food is delayed. That is the constraint we need you to work with.
- 18 **Tomas:** I will carry that ⁹ _____ into the conversation. I will not represent your departure as flexible or assume you can stay longer.
- 19 **Riley:** Thank you. Please check before changing anything. We still have the original order for now.
- 20 **Tomas:** Agreed. I will avoid a ¹⁰ _____ I cannot support. Your order status, the current estimate, and any decision we make next will stay clear.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. readiness estimate | 2. remaining time | 3. fixed time | 4. departure deadline | 5. rush request | 6. timing discussion | 7. table update | 8. Pickup | 9. timing constraint | 10. completion promise

Anchor a new estimate

F Say it

At 8:10, the kitchen estimates six more minutes for a dish. The guests need to leave at 8:30. No faster alternative or guaranteed table-delivery time has been confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

8:30 / 8:16 / 8:10 / unconfirmed

Server: "The estimate starts from ¹ _____."

Guest: "That points to around ² _____."

Server: "Your departure requirement is ³ _____."

Guest: "A faster alternative remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. 8:10 | 2. 8:16 | 3. 8:30 | 4. unconfirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the answers and read the delay conversation. Stress seven thirty, another eight minutes, and seven fifty.
2. Switch roles. Repeat the readiness explanation without promising table arrival or enough time to eat.
3. Complete the new-estimate transfer. Check the arithmetic and key, then read both the approximate readiness and fixed departure times.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Pasta ordered, risotto delivered

A Read the situation

Acknowledge an order mismatch, offer a specific remedy, and separate replacement timing from a bill-adjustment decision.

05

At table 3, guest Alex ordered vegetable pasta but received mushroom risotto. The ticket confirms vegetable pasta. Server Dana checks the mismatch and learns that the kitchen can remake the pasta with an estimated ten-minute wait. Dana may offer that replacement, but any bill adjustment requires shift lead review. The cause of the wrong delivery is not established. No allergy is reported. Alex has not accepted the remake at the start, and neither compensation nor a guaranteed ten-minute arrival has been approved.

PEOPLE / Alex: Guest at table 3 | Dana: Server

AN APOLOGY CAN BE DIRECT

Name the mismatch without making the guest prove an error already confirmed by the ticket. Take responsibility for the next step without guessing which colleague caused the problem. A sincere apology does not require inventing a free meal or a guaranteed preparation time.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the ticket confirm?

A A canceled order

C Mushroom risotto

B Vegetable pasta

D Two identical risottos

2. What replacement can Dana offer?

A A completed refund

C A guaranteed two-minute steak

B A pasta remake with an estimated ten-minute wait

D An automatic free meal

3. Who must review a bill adjustment?

A An unnamed supplier

C Any guest at a nearby table

B The shift lead

D Dana automatically without review

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

order mismatch

Difference between what was ordered and what was delivered or recorded.

IN USE acknowledge the order mismatch

remake

Newly prepared replacement for a dish that needs correction.

IN USE request a remake

replacement offer

Proposed substitute or corrected item that the guest may accept.

IN USE explain the replacement offer

service recovery

Actions addressing a service failure and its effect on the guest.

IN USE manage service recovery

apology

Direct expression of regret for an error or inconvenience.

IN USE offer a clear apology

inconvenience

Practical difficulty or disruption caused to the guest.

IN USE acknowledge the inconvenience

ticket check

Review of the order record to establish what was entered.

IN USE perform a ticket check

delivered dish

Food actually brought to the guest.

IN USE identify the delivered dish

ordered dish

Food the guest requested.

IN USE confirm the ordered dish

confirmed mismatch

Discrepancy established by the available record and observation.

IN USE state the confirmed mismatch

cause

Reason an error occurred, which may require further investigation.

IN USE avoid guessing the cause

blame

Attribution of fault to a person or group.

IN USE avoid unsupported blame

Precision check

The ticket confirms pasta, so the server can acknowledge the mismatch without guessing its cause. The kitchen offers a remake; the guest still needs to accept it. An available remedy is not the same as a completed resolution.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

remedy

Action intended to put a problem right.

IN USE offer an available remedy

estimated wait

Approximate expected delay before a specified next event.

IN USE explain the estimated wait

acceptance

Agreement to a proposed option.

IN USE confirm acceptance

bill adjustment

Authorized change to an amount on the guest's bill.

IN USE request a bill adjustment

comp

Informal restaurant term for an item provided without charge under authorization.

IN USE obtain approval for a comp

discount

Reduction from a stated price.

IN USE authorize a discount

refund

Return of money already paid.

IN USE process an approved refund

void

Cancellation of a transaction or entry through the relevant system procedure.

IN USE record an authorized void

shift lead

Person coordinating service decisions during a shift.

IN USE consult the shift lead

approval limit

Boundary on the decisions someone may authorize.

IN USE observe an approval limit

resolution status

Whether the proposed correction has actually been agreed and completed.

IN USE confirm the resolution status

follow-up check

Later confirmation that the corrective action occurred and met the stated need.

IN USE make a follow-up check

Precision check

A remake, comp, discount, void, and refund are different actions. A refund returns paid money; a bill adjustment may happen before payment. Follow actual approval and payment procedures, and do not describe shift-lead review as a completed financial decision.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE MISMATCH

"You ordered vegetable pasta, and we brought mushroom risotto."

REFER TO THE RECORD

"I checked the ticket, and it confirms the pasta."

OFFER THE ACTUAL REMEDY

"The kitchen can remake the vegetable pasta."

ASK FOR ACCEPTANCE

"Would you like that replacement?"

APOLOGIZE DIRECTLY

"I am sorry; that is not the dish you ordered."

AVOID BLAMING THE GUEST

"You do not need to explain the order again."

STATE THE ESTIMATED WAIT

"The current estimate is ten minutes."

KEEP TIMING HONEST

"I cannot guarantee an exact arrival time."

We brought

Acknowledges the service error without assigning unsupported individual blame.

Confirms

Identifies evidence for what was ordered.

Can remake

Describes an available action, not one already completed.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID GUESSING FAULT

"I have not established how the mismatch happened."

SEPARATE THE FINANCIAL QUESTION

"Any bill adjustment needs the shift lead's review."

NAME THE NEXT ACTION

"I will bring the bill question to the shift lead."

CHECK COMPLETION LATER

"I will confirm that the correct dish reaches you."

ADDRESS THE PRACTICAL EFFECT

"I understand that the extra wait affects your meal."

DO NOT PROMISE AN UNAUTHORIZED COMP

"I cannot confirm a free item before approval."

KEEP CONSENT CLEAR

"I will wait for your go-ahead before arranging the replacement."

CONFIRM THE NEXT STEP

"I will check the bill question first, then come back for your decision."

Would you like

Requests the guest's decision.

Current estimate

Preserves uncertainty in preparation timing.

Needs review

Marks a pending decision rather than approval.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which apology fits the facts?

- A** I am sorry; the ticket confirms pasta, but we brought risotto.
- B** I am sorry; your order was entered as risotto.
- C** I am sorry; the kitchen has confirmed who took the wrong plate.
- D** I am sorry; I have already removed the charge.

2. Which offer is authorized?

- A** A guaranteed ten-minute arrival and free meal
- B** A refund already completed
- C** Any replacement at any price with no check
- D** A pasta remake with an estimated ten-minute wait

3. Which statement keeps the financial decision accurate?

- A** I will ask the shift lead to review the bill question.
- B** I have already approved a comp.
- C** Every remake legally requires a refund.
- D** The kitchen estimate authorizes a discount.

4. When can the issue be described as fully resolved?

- A** Before the guest accepts an offer
- B** As soon as someone guesses the cause
- C** After the relevant agreed actions are actually completed and checked
- D** Immediately when an apology is spoken

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

Pasta ordered, risotto delivered

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

bill adjustment / shift lead / cause / estimated wait / next step / complimentary / go-ahead / check back / remake / mistake

- 01 **Alex:** Excuse me, this is mushroom risotto. I ordered vegetable pasta. Could you check? Everyone else has their main, and I do not want to start the wrong dish.
- 02 **Dana:** I am sorry about the ¹ _____. The ticket says vegetable pasta. We brought you something different.
- 03 **Alex:** Can I still get the pasta? I had been looking forward to it, but I am worried the others will finish before mine arrives.
- 04 **Dana:** The kitchen can make a ² _____. Their current estimate is ten minutes. Would you like me to arrange that?
- 05 **Alex:** Is that ten minutes from now? We have already waited for the first round, so I need a realistic idea before I decide.
- 06 **Dana:** They have quoted an ³ _____ of ten minutes. I cannot promise the exact arrival time, and I understand another wait disrupts your meal.
- 07 **Alex:** Will there be anything off the bill? I do not feel comfortable paying as though everything arrived correctly.
- 08 **Dana:** I can ask for a ⁴ _____. Our shift lead needs to review that; I can offer the replacement but cannot approve the charge change myself.
- 09 **Alex:** I thought the replacement might be free. Are you saying you cannot promise that yet?
- 10 **Dana:** That is right. I cannot promise it will be ⁵ _____ before the lead decides. I will explain both the wrong dish and the additional wait.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Alex:** Was the order entered incorrectly? I heard you say the ticket has pasta on it.
- 12 **Dana:** The ticket is correct. I do not yet know the ⁶ _____ of the delivery error. I can acknowledge it without guessing which colleague made it.
- 13 **Alex:** If I do take the pasta, will you make sure it is mine this time? I would rather not go through this again.
- 14 **Dana:** Yes. I will ⁷ _____ on the corrected dish and keep you updated if the kitchen's timing changes.
- 15 **Alex:** Before I decide, could you speak to the lead about the bill? Please do not start the replacement yet.
- 16 **Dana:** Understood. I will wait for your ⁸ _____. Hearing the offer is not the same as agreeing to it.
- 17 **Alex:** Thank you. Can the lead speak with me if there are questions? I would prefer to explain what the extra wait means for us.
- 18 **Dana:** I will pass that request to the ⁹ _____, along with the ticket, what arrived, and the ten-minute estimate.
- 19 **Alex:** All right. For now, please check the bill question. Then I will decide whether to wait for the pasta.
- 20 **Dana:** That is our ¹⁰ _____. I am sorry your meal has been interrupted. I will return with the decision rather than leave you wondering what is happening.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. mistake | 2. remake | 3. estimated wait | 4. bill adjustment | 5. complimentary | 6. cause | 7. check back | 8. go-ahead | 9. shift lead | 10. next step

Offer a different correction

F Say it

Table 7 ordered lentil soup but received tomato soup. The ticket confirms lentil soup. A remake is available with an estimated seven-minute wait. Lead Noor must review any bill adjustment.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

lentil / Noor / seven / tomato

Server: "The ticket confirms ¹ _____ soup."

Guest: "The delivered soup was ² _____."

Server: "The estimated remake wait is ³ _____ minutes."

Guest: "The bill question goes to ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. lentil | 2. tomato | 3. seven | 4. Noor

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the cloze answers. Read the apology and offer with a partner, acknowledging the wrong dish without assigning blame.
2. Switch roles. Keep Alex's go-ahead pending and the bill decision with the shift lead throughout.
3. Complete the soup transfer and check its key. Repeat the dish names, estimated wait, and named lead accurately.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

What does three ways mean?

A Read the situation

Clarify equal payments versus item-based checks, state the arithmetic, and confirm the method before processing payment.

Three diners have a fictional \$72 bill, with all listed charges included. Guest Morgan asks to split it "three ways." The restaurant can arrange equal payments or separate checks by item before payment is processed. Server Jules must ask which method the diners mean. Equal shares would be \$24 each; item-based shares cannot be calculated without the item allocation. No additional charge, tip decision, completed payment, or refund is supplied. Morgan later confirms that the group wants three equal payments, and Jules reads back that choice before processing.

PEOPLE / Morgan: Guest speaking for the group | Jules: Server

DO NOT MAKE THE SOCIAL DECISION FOR THE TABLE

Guests may use split loosely, while differing about who should pay for shared dishes. Clarify the method without judging fairness or announcing private assumptions about relationships. Keep the conversation practical and confirm amounts before a payment is submitted.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the stated bill total?

- A \$72 with all listed charges included
- C \$24 for the entire table

- B \$72 plus an invented charge
- D An unknown total

2. What does three ways need to clarify?

- A Equal payments or separate checks by item
- C Whether the meal happened yesterday

- B Whether there are three diners at all
- D Whether every diner ordered identical food

3. What is each equal share?

- A \$36
- C \$27

- B \$18
- D \$24

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

check

Restaurant bill listing the guest's charges.

IN USE bring the check

bill total

Amount due for the listed charges.

IN USE confirm the bill total

itemized bill

Bill showing individual items or charges.

IN USE review the itemized bill

split payment

Payment of one amount through multiple payments or payers.

IN USE arrange a split payment

equal share

Same portion of the total assigned to each person.

IN USE calculate an equal share

separate check

Individual bill assigned to a particular diner or group.

IN USE prepare separate checks

item allocation

Assignment of particular ordered items to particular payers.

IN USE confirm the item allocation

shared item

Dish or charge used by more than one diner.

IN USE allocate a shared item

allocation method

Agreed way of dividing the total or items.

IN USE clarify the allocation method

subtotal

Sum before the specified additional components included in a final total.

IN USE distinguish the subtotal

listed charge

Amount explicitly shown on the bill.

IN USE verify a listed charge

service charge

Charge imposed under the restaurant's stated terms, distinct from a discretionary tip.

IN USE explain a service charge

06

Precision check

Three equal shares of \$72 are \$24 each. That arithmetic does not show what each diner consumed. Separate checks by item need an agreed allocation, including shared items, before amounts can be determined.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

gratuity

Usually a tip; an automatic mandatory charge may instead be a service charge under applicable rules.

IN USE clarify a gratuity

payment method

Means used to pay, such as a card or cash.

IN USE confirm the payment method

card terminal

Device used to submit a card payment.

IN USE present the card terminal

authorization

Approval stage for a payment under the relevant payment system.

IN USE check payment authorization

payment receipt

Record acknowledging the payment transaction.

IN USE provide a payment receipt

outstanding balance

Amount that remains unpaid.

IN USE confirm the outstanding balance

partial payment

Payment of less than the full amount due.

IN USE record a partial payment

payment confirmation

Evidence or acknowledgment that a payment was completed at the relevant stage.

IN USE check payment confirmation

rounding

Adjustment to an available monetary precision under the relevant method.

IN USE explain rounding

duplicate charge

Repeated charge for the same item or transaction where duplication is at issue.

IN USE investigate a duplicate charge

reconciliation

Comparison of payments and amounts due to check that records agree.

IN USE complete payment reconciliation

settle the bill

Complete payment of the amount due.

IN USE settle the bill

06

Precision check

The scenario supplies a total with all listed charges included; do not add a guessed fee or assume a tip decision. Confirm actual restaurant terms and the guest-selected payment amounts. Agreeing a split is not proof that money has been collected.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CLARIFY THE REQUEST

"Do you mean three equal payments or separate checks by item?"

EXPLAIN EQUAL SHARES

"Three equal shares would be \$24 each."

HANDLE SHARED DISHES

"How should the shared items be allocated?"

CHECK THE TIMING

"We can arrange either method before processing payment."

STATE THE TOTAL

"The bill total is \$72."

EXPLAIN THE OTHER METHOD

"For item-based checks, I need to know which items belong to each person."

AVOID A FAIRNESS ASSUMPTION

"I will use the method your group agrees on."

CONFIRM THE SELECTED METHOD

"You would like three equal payments, correct?"

06

Do you mean

Offers two concrete interpretations instead of making a guess.

Would be

Gives the amount conditional on choosing equal shares.

By item

Refers to consumption allocation rather than equal portions of the total.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

READ BACK THE AMOUNT

"That is \$24 for each of the three payments."

SEPARATE THE TIP DECISION

"Would you like to decide on any optional tip separately?"

CHECK THE TERMINAL AMOUNT

"Please check the amount before confirming the payment."

OFFER A RECEIPT

"Would each person like their own payment receipt?"

DO NOT INVENT AN EXTRA CHARGE

"The stated total already includes all listed charges."

KEEP PAYMENT STATUS FACTUAL

"The split is agreed, but no payment has been processed yet."

TRACK WHAT REMAINS

"We need to record each actual payment against the balance."

CLOSE BEFORE PROCESSING

"Three equal payments of \$24, against the \$72 total."

06

Before processing

Locates the clarification before a transaction occurs.

Each

Makes clear that twenty-four dollars applies to every equal share.

Agreed, but not processed

Separates a payment plan from completed payment.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

1. Which first question resolves the ambiguity?
 - A Three ways always means three unequal checks, right?
 - B Do you mean equal payments or separate checks by item?
 - C You all ate exactly the same amount, correct?
 - D Shall I split only the food and leave the shared charges on one card?

2. Which arithmetic is correct for equal shares?
 - A \$72 divided by 3 is \$36 each.
 - B Three payments of \$24 leave \$24 unpaid.
 - C Three payments of \$72 equal the original bill.
 - D \$72 divided by 3 is \$24 each.

3. What is needed to calculate item-based checks?
 - A An agreed allocation of items and shared charges
 - B Only the number of diners
 - C A guessed tip amount
 - D An assumption that all dishes cost the same

4. What does confirmation of three equal payments establish?
 - A That every card has been charged
 - B That a refund was issued
 - C That all fees may be added again
 - D The intended allocation, not completed payment

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

What does three ways mean?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

payment confirmation / bill total / outstanding balance / listed charge / item allocation / card terminal / allocation method / equal shares / payment receipt / split payment

06

- 01 **Morgan:** Could we split this three ways, please? There are three of us, and we would like to sort it out before everyone starts reaching for a card.
- 02 **Jules:** Certainly. Do you mean three ¹ _____, or would you like separate checks according to what each person ordered? We can arrange either before payment.
- 03 **Morgan:** What would it come to if we divided it equally? We shared a couple of dishes, so that may be easiest.
- 04 **Jules:** The ² _____ is seventy-two dollars. Divided equally among three people, that is twenty-four dollars each. Those three amounts add back to seventy-two.
- 05 **Morgan:** If someone wants to pay only for their own meal, can you do that too? We would need to sort out the shared starters.
- 06 **Jules:** Yes. That requires an ³ _____. We would also need your agreement about shared items rather than assume an equal division of those.
- 07 **Morgan:** We did share some food, so equal payments may be simpler for us. Let me confirm with the others before you enter anything.
- 08 **Jules:** Of course. The ⁴ _____ should be your group's choice. I will wait rather than treat our discussion as permission to process a payment.
- 09 **Morgan:** They have agreed. We want three equal payments, not separate bills based on individual dishes. Twenty-four each sounds right to us.
- 10 **Jules:** Thank you. I will arrange the ⁵ _____ as three payments of twenty-four dollars against the seventy-two-dollar total. Please confirm that is the method you want.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Morgan:** Yes, that is correct. I want to make sure the number on the terminal will match that amount, not the whole seventy-two dollars.
- 12 **Jules:** We will check each amount on the ⁶ _____ before it is confirmed. Agreeing twenty-four each does not mean a payment has already been taken.
- 13 **Morgan:** Does the seventy-two already include everything listed on this check? I just want to be sure we are dividing the final figure.
- 14 **Jules:** Correct. The ⁷ _____ amounts are included in the stated total. I will not invent an additional fee or assume a tip choice from this request.
- 15 **Morgan:** Could we each have a receipt for our own payment? Two of us need one for our records.
- 16 **Jules:** We can provide the relevant ⁸ _____ through our payment process. It needs to reflect the payment that is actually completed, not just the split we have agreed.
- 17 **Morgan:** We will pay one at a time, then. Could you show each person the amount before they tap?
- 18 **Jules:** Yes. The ⁹ _____ must reflect the actual payments recorded. Three agreed amounts are not a substitute for checking which transactions have completed.
- 19 **Morgan:** Yes, twenty-four each. We are all agreed now. You can bring the terminal when you are ready.
- 20 **Jules:** Exactly. We will obtain ¹⁰ _____ through the actual process. Three equal payments of twenty-four dollars is the instruction I am working from.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. equal shares | 2. bill total | 3. item allocation | 4. allocation method | 5. split payment | 6. card terminal | 7. listed charge | 8. payment receipt | 9. outstanding balance | 10. payment confirmation

Clarify four ways

F Say it

Four diners have a \$96 total with all listed charges included. The restaurant supports equal payments or item-based checks before payment. The diners confirm equal payments. No payment has been processed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

equal / ninety-six / twenty-four / processed

Server: "You have chosen ¹ _____ payments."

Guest: "Each share is ² _____ dollars."

Server: "The full total remains ³ _____ dollars."

Guest: "The payments are not yet ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. equal | 2. twenty-four | 3. ninety-six | 4. processed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the answers. Read the exchange, contrasting equal payments with separate checks by item.
2. Switch roles. Say three payments of twenty-four against seventy-two, then confirm that agreement is not completed payment.
3. Complete and check the ninety-six-dollar transfer. Read four equal shares of twenty-four without changing the total.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

An empty plate still in use

A Read the situation

Check permission to clear specific items and coordinate shared service without inferring that an empty plate is finished.

At table 2, one diner has an empty plate, but the shared vegetable dish still contains food. The diner is using that plate for another portion. Server Mina and food runner Leo need to coordinate clearing. Extra sharing plates can be offered, but active items should remain unless the guest agrees otherwise. No request to end the meal or prepare the table for new guests has been made. The colleagues discuss the words Leo can use, then agree that he will ask what can be cleared rather than silently remove the plate.

PEOPLE / Mina: Server responsible for table 2 | Leo: Food runner helping with clearing

07

ASK RATHER THAN APPLY A DINING STEREOTYPE

Dining customs differ, but nationality is not a reliable instruction for a particular table. An empty plate, a pause, or a cutlery position can be ambiguous. Ask a short question about the actual item and respect the answer without making guests explain their culture.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Why is the empty plate still needed?

- A** The table is being reset for new guests.
- B** The plate is abandoned as an established fact.
- C** The diner is using it for another portion.
- D** The meal has definitely ended.

2. What remains in the shared dish?

- A** Nothing at all
- B** Vegetables
- C** Only an empty serving vessel
- D** A confirmed discarded meal

3. What may the team offer?

- A** A bill adjustment already approved
- B** Extra sharing plates
- C** Unrequested removal of all active dishes
- D** A new reservation without asking

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

clear

Remove dining items that are ready to be taken away.

IN USE ask before clearing

pre-bus

Remove agreed finished items during a meal before the table's final clearing.

IN USE pre-bus discreetly

busser

Team member who supports clearing, resetting, and related dining-room tasks.

IN USE coordinate with the busser

food runner

Colleague who carries prepared dishes to guests and may assist service.

IN USE brief the food runner

sharing plate

Plate provided for taking a portion from a shared dish.

IN USE offer a sharing plate

shared dish

Food presented for more than one person to serve from.

IN USE leave the shared dish

serving utensil

Tool used to transfer food from a serving dish to a plate.

IN USE provide a serving utensil

place setting

Arrangement of dining items for one person.

IN USE maintain the place setting

side plate

Small plate used for bread, sides, or another specified purpose.

IN USE offer a side plate

sideboard

Service furniture or station used to hold dining-room supplies.

IN USE restock the sideboard

service station

Area holding supplies and equipment for dining-room work.

IN USE organize the service station

cutlery

Knives, forks, and spoons used for eating.

IN USE replace the cutlery

Precision check

Empty describes the plate contents at one moment. Finished describes the guest no longer needing it. The two are not equivalent here. A shared dish with food and an empty individual plate can belong to the same continuing meal.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

flatware

Common US term for eating utensils such as knives, forks, and spoons.

IN USE provide clean flatware

crockery

Plates, bowls, and other ceramic dining vessels.

IN USE handle the crockery

glassware

Drinking vessels made of glass.

IN USE collect finished glassware

active item

Item still being used or needed by a guest.

IN USE leave active items

finished item

Item the guest has finished using and agrees can be removed.

IN USE identify finished items

clearing permission

Guest agreement to remove a particular item.

IN USE obtain clearing permission

service cue

Action or signal that may suggest a service need but can require clarification.

IN USE clarify a service cue

meal pace

Speed and rhythm at which guests are eating.

IN USE respect the meal pace

table reset

Preparation of a cleared table for its next guests.

IN USE begin an authorized table reset

table turnover

Transition from one party's use of a table to the next.

IN USE manage table turnover

unobtrusive service

Assistance that meets guest needs without unnecessary interruption.

IN USE provide unobtrusive service

guest preference

Individual request about how service should be provided.

IN USE confirm the guest preference

Precision check

May I clear this plate? asks about a particular item. Are you finished with everything? is broader and can create pressure or misunderstanding. Identify the item, wait for the answer, and keep the agreed clearing action aligned across the team.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ASK ABOUT AN ITEM

"May I clear this plate, or are you still using it?"

CHECK THE SHARED DISH

"Would you like the vegetables to stay on the table?"

AVOID AN ASSUMPTION

"An empty plate does not necessarily mean the guest has finished."

STATE THE OBSERVED FACT

"The shared dish still has food in it."

ACCEPT CONTINUED USE

"Of course; I will leave it for your next portion."

OFFER PRACTICAL HELP

"Would extra sharing plates be useful?"

COORDINATE THE TEAM

"Please leave that plate; it is still in use."

KEEP THE QUESTION NARROW

"Ask about the specific item rather than the whole meal."

This plate

Makes the permission request specific.

Or are you still using it

Gives a comfortable way to decline clearing.

Of course

Accepts the preference without making it an inconvenience.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

WAIT FOR PERMISSION

"Let the guest answer before reaching for the plate."

AVOID CULTURAL GUESSES

"We should ask this table what they prefer."

PRESERVE THE SHARED ARRANGEMENT

"Leave the serving dish and active plates in place."

PASS ON THE PREFERENCE

"The diner is keeping the plate for another portion."

RESPECT A REFUSAL

"Certainly; I will leave it where it is."

SEPARATE STAGES

"Clearing one finished item is not a table reset."

KEEP EXTRA ITEMS OPTIONAL

"We can offer more plates without adding them automatically."

CLOSE THE SERVICE LOOP

"Confirm what may be cleared and tell the colleague helping you."

Still

Signals continued use despite the empty surface.

Would be useful

Offers help instead of imposing equipment.

Not necessarily

Challenges an assumption without saying the cue is never meaningful.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which question is most appropriate?

- A** Shall I clear everyone's plates now?
- B** Would you like the bill now the plates are empty?
- C** May I remove the shared vegetables with this plate?
- D** May I clear this plate, or are you still using it?

2. What does the empty plate establish?

- A** A request for the bill
- B** Its current contents, not that it is no longer needed
- C** Permission to remove every dish
- D** The diner's nationality

3. Which instruction should Mina give Leo?

- A** Treat the meal as complete.
- B** Add an unrequested charge for extra plates.
- C** Leave the active plate and ask what may be cleared.
- D** Remove the vegetables because one plate is empty.

4. How should cultural differences be handled?

- A** Infer the answer from nationality.
- B** Use one cutlery position as universal proof.
- C** Require guests to explain their cultural background.
- D** Ask the individual table about its preference.

[Answers and explanations: page 97.](#)

An empty plate still in use

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

sharing plate / table reset / meal pace / clearing permission / service cue / guest preference / finished item / shared dish / active item / Unobtrusive service

07

- 01 **Leo:** Mina, one plate at table two is empty. I was about to take it away, but the vegetable dish in the middle still has food.
- 02 **Mina:** Please leave that ¹ _____ for now. The diner is using the plate for another portion, so empty does not mean finished in this situation.
- 03 **Leo:** I see. They are sharing, so the empty plate is not finished with. I will leave it where it is.
- 04 **Mina:** A ² _____ can help us notice a need, but it is not always permission. We should check the actual item before reaching across the table.
- 05 **Leo:** What would you say without interrupting the conversation too much? I want the question to be clear but not sound as though I am trying to hurry them.
- 06 **Mina:** Ask for ³ _____ briefly: May I clear this plate, or are you still using it? Then pause long enough for an answer.
- 07 **Leo:** If they say they are using it for more vegetables, I can simply say of course and leave it. I do not need them to justify it.
- 08 **Mina:** Exactly. Respect the ⁴ _____. We should not turn a small service question into a discussion of their dining customs or why they want to keep the plate.
- 09 **Leo:** We can offer extra plates as well, correct? That might make sharing easier, but I should not bring a stack of them without asking.
- 10 **Mina:** Yes, offer a ⁵ _____ or more if useful. Say, Would extra sharing plates help? We have that option available, but it should remain their choice.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Leo:** I will keep the vegetables in place too. There is still food there, and no one has asked us to remove the dish.
- 12 **Mina:** Good. The ⁶ _____ and the individual plate belong to the same ongoing meal. Do not treat them as unrelated clearing decisions.
- 13 **Leo:** If another guest has actually finished with a glass or plate, may I check that item separately? I do not want to leave everything unnecessarily.
- 14 **Mina:** Yes. A ⁷ _____ can be handled separately. Ask specifically, and keep the action narrow enough that we do not accidentally clear something another diner is using.
- 15 **Leo:** Right. I will check the glass separately, not start taking the whole setting away while they still have food.
- 16 **Mina:** Correct. A ⁸ _____ is another stage. Our immediate task is to support this table's meal, not turn an empty plate into a deadline.
- 17 **Leo:** I will ask the diner, leave the active items, and offer extra sharing plates. Then I will tell you what they want so we stay consistent.
- 18 **Mina:** Thank you. That supports their ⁹ _____. It also prevents a second colleague from returning a moment later and asking to take the same plate.
- 19 **Leo:** I will keep it brief at the table. May I clear this plate, or are you still using it? Then I wait for the answer.
- 20 **Mina:** Exactly. ¹⁰ _____ means noticing, asking briefly, and following the answer. Clear what is agreed, leave what is active, and keep the team informed.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. active item | 2. service cue | 3. clearing permission | 4. guest preference | 5. sharing plate | 6. shared dish | 7. finished item | 8. table reset | 9. meal pace | 10. Unobtrusive service

Check a shared dessert plate

F Say it

At table 9, an empty plate is still needed for more shared dessert. The dessert dish contains food. Extra small plates can be offered. No permission to clear the active plate has been given.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

given / needed / dessert / offered

Server: "The empty plate is still ¹ _____."

Colleague: "The shared dish contains ² _____."

Server: "Extra small plates can be ³ _____."

Colleague: "Clearing permission has not been ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. needed | 2. dessert | 3. offered | 4. given

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the answers. Read Mina and Leo's exchange, then repeat the exact plate-clearing question in turn.
2. Switch roles. Pause after the permission question; distinguish an empty plate from a plate no longer needed.
3. Complete and check the dessert transfer. Repeat the offer of extra plates without implying clearing permission.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Two tables, two unfinished tasks

A Read the situation

Give a concise table-by-table handover that separates meal stage, payment status, and an unresolved charge query.

At 8:00, outgoing server Ben hands tables 4 and 5 to Maya. Table 4 has received its mains, but dessert has not been ordered. Table 5 has an open check and a pending query about a possible duplicate coffee charge. The shift lead is reviewing that query; no duplicate has yet been confirmed and no adjustment is approved. Ben needs Maya to accept both follow-ups explicitly. The handover does not establish a dessert order, a settled bill, or a resolved coffee issue. Maya agrees to take responsibility for the next guest-facing steps.

PEOPLE / Ben: Outgoing server | Maya: Incoming server

08

A HANDOVER IS AN ACCEPTED RESPONSIBILITY

A rushed list of table numbers can hide unfinished work. State the meal stage, the open request, and the person handling any decision. Ask the receiving colleague to repeat the important details so that moving between shifts does not make a live guest concern disappear.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is table 4's meal stage?

A Mains not yet ordered

B Meal canceled

C Mains served; dessert not ordered

D Dessert served and paid

2. What is table 5's check status?

A Never created

B Open

C Paid and closed

D Refunded in full

3. Who is reviewing the possible duplicate coffee charge?

A The guest as sole approver of every system change

B No one

C The shift lead

D Maya as an already completed decision

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

section

Group of tables assigned to a server or service team.

IN USE take over a section

live table

Table still receiving service or awaiting completion of a task.

IN USE identify live tables

outgoing server

Colleague transferring responsibility at a shift or section change.

IN USE brief the outgoing server

incoming server

Colleague accepting responsibility for the next service period.

IN USE confirm the incoming server

handover

Transfer of relevant information and responsibility between colleagues.

IN USE complete the section handover

handover time

Time at which the responsibility transfer is recorded or agreed.

IN USE state the handover time

table status

Current service stage and relevant conditions for a table.

IN USE summarize the table status

mains served

Status indicating main dishes have reached the guests.

IN USE confirm mains served

dessert decision

Guest choice about whether and what dessert to order.

IN USE follow up the dessert decision

open check

Bill that has not been settled and closed in the relevant system.

IN USE monitor the open check

pending query

Question awaiting an answer or decision.

IN USE carry forward a pending query

suspected duplicate

Possible repeated charge that still requires verification.

IN USE review a suspected duplicate

Precision check

Mains served does not imply dessert ordered. Open check does not imply the bill is correct or the disputed item is wrong. A possible duplicate charge must remain a query until the review establishes the result.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

charge review

Examination of whether a billed amount is correct.

IN USE request a charge review

decision owner

Person authorized or responsible for resolving a specified question.

IN USE identify the decision owner

service owner

Person responsible for the guest-facing follow-up.

IN USE name the service owner

accepted follow-up

Next action explicitly taken on by the receiving colleague.

IN USE record an accepted follow-up

read-back confirmation

Repetition demonstrating that the receiving colleague understood the important details.

IN USE obtain read-back confirmation

closed check

Bill marked settled and closed through the actual payment process.

IN USE verify a closed check

status change

Actual transition from one confirmed state to another.

IN USE communicate a status change

exception note

Record highlighting an issue outside routine service flow.

IN USE preserve an exception note

unresolved item

Task or question that has not been completed or answered.

IN USE track the unresolved item

continuity of service

Uninterrupted attention to guest needs across staff changes.

IN USE maintain continuity of service

handover gap

Missing information or ownership during a transfer of responsibility.

IN USE prevent a handover gap

follow-through

Completion of an accepted action and appropriate communication of its result.

IN USE ensure follow-through

Precision check

The shift lead owns the charge decision; Maya can own the guest-facing update and follow-up. Explicit acceptance keeps these roles connected. Do not close the issue merely because the outgoing server has finished a shift.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN THE TRANSFER

"It is 8:00, and I am handing over tables 4 and 5."

KEEP DESSERT ACCURATE

"Dessert has not been ordered."

STATE TABLE 5'S BALANCE STATUS

"Table 5 has an open check."

PRESERVE UNCERTAINTY

"The duplication has not been confirmed."

STATE TABLE 4'S STAGE

"Table 4 has its mains."

NAME THE FIRST FOLLOW-UP

"Please check whether table 4 wants dessert."

IDENTIFY THE QUERY

"They have asked about a possible duplicate coffee charge."

NAME THE DECISION OWNER

"The shift lead is reviewing the charge query."

08

Has its mains

Describes delivery, not the next course choice.

Has not been ordered

Prevents a future possibility from becoming a recorded order.

Possible duplicate

Preserves the uncertainty under review.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID FALSE COMPENSATION

"No adjustment has been approved yet."

READ BACK TABLE 4

"I will follow up dessert without treating it as already ordered."

KEEP PAYMENT SEPARATE

"The check remains open until the actual payment process is completed."

AVOID A FALSE CLOSURE

"The issue is not resolved just because the section changes hands."

ASK FOR ACCEPTANCE

"Can you take both follow-ups?"

READ BACK TABLE 5

"I will track the coffee review and update the guests."

PRESERVE THE RECORD

"Keep the unresolved query visible in the handover notes."

CLOSE WITH OWNERSHIP

"Maya has accepted both guest-facing follow-ups; the shift lead retains the charge review."

08

Is reviewing

Marks an active process, not a completed decision.

Can you take

Requests explicit ownership rather than assuming it.

Remains open

Keeps the payment state tied to actual events.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handover for table 4 is correct?

- A Mains still need ordering
- B The table has left and paid
- C Mains served; dessert not ordered; follow up the dessert choice.
- D Dessert already entered for everyone

2. Which coffee description is justified?

- A A completed refund
- B An error already removed from every record
- C A possible duplicate charge under shift-lead review
- D A confirmed fraudulent charge

3. Which ownership arrangement is clear?

- A Ben's departure automatically closes the query.
- B Maya announces approval before receiving a decision.
- C Maya accepts guest follow-up while the shift lead reviews the charge.
- D Everyone assumes someone else will handle it.

4. What must precede calling table 5's check closed?

- A The actual relevant payment and closure process
- B Merely changing servers
- C Writing possible duplicate in a note
- D Assuming dessert is unnecessary

Answers and explanations: page 99.

Two tables, two unfinished tasks

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

mains served / open check / continuity of service / status change / dessert decision / service owner / read-back confirmation / exception note / suspected duplicate / handover

08

- 01 **Ben:** Maya, it is eight o'clock. I need to hand over tables four and five before I leave the section. Each has a different follow-up still open.
- 02 **Maya:** I am ready for the ¹ _____. Please give me the current stage and unfinished request for each table so I can take them on clearly.
- 03 **Ben:** Table four has received its mains. Dessert has not been ordered, so please check their choice when it is appropriate in the service.
- 04 **Maya:** Understood: ² _____, dessert not ordered. I will not enter desserts on the assumption that your mention of them means the guests have already chosen.
- 05 **Ben:** Exactly. Ask about dessert when they are ready. There is nothing on the dessert ticket to chase.
- 06 **Maya:** I will handle the ³ _____ with table four. That is the first task I am accepting. What is happening at table five?
- 07 **Ben:** Table five still has an open check. They asked about what may be a duplicate coffee charge, and the shift lead is reviewing that question.
- 08 **Maya:** So the ⁴ _____ has a live query attached. I should not treat the bill as settled or the coffee line as already corrected.
- 09 **Ben:** Exactly. I have not been given a review result, and no bill adjustment has been approved. The guest needs an accurate update once there is a decision.
- 10 **Maya:** I will preserve the wording ⁵ _____. I will not tell them the charge is definitely wrong simply because a query has been raised.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Ben:** The lead has the bill question. Can you check for the answer and keep table five updated after I leave?
- 12 **Maya:** I can be the ⁶ _____ for that follow-up. The shift lead makes the relevant decision; I track it and explain the actual outcome to the guests.
- 13 **Ben:** That is the distinction. Please keep the unresolved question visible in the notes as well, so it does not disappear when the section assignment changes.
- 14 **Maya:** I will retain the ⁷ _____ and the current status. A change of server should not make a pending charge question look like routine payment completed.
- 15 **Ben:** Can you read back both tasks once more? I want to be sure I have not mixed the table numbers while we are moving between them.
- 16 **Maya:** My ⁸ _____ is table four: follow up the dessert choice. Table five: track the shift-lead coffee review and give the guests the actual update.
- 17 **Ben:** Correct. Five is still open, and we have no approved adjustment. Please keep that separate from the fact you have taken the table.
- 18 **Maya:** Agreed. Any ⁹ _____ will reflect what actually occurs. Accepted follow-up is not the same as completed service, approved adjustment, or settled payment.
- 19 **Ben:** Good. You have both follow-ups, and the shift lead still has the charge decision. That gives each next step a clear person to contact.
- 20 **Maya:** Yes, I accept both. I will maintain ¹⁰ _____ for the two tables, check the pending decision, and keep the records aligned with what the guests are actually told.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. handover | 2. mains served | 3. dessert decision | 4. open check | 5. suspected duplicate | 6. service owner | 7. exception note | 8. read-back confirmation | 9. status change | 10. continuity of service

Hand over two different tables

F Say it

At 9:00, Noor takes tables 8 and 9. Table 8 has mains served and no dessert order. Table 9 has an open check with a possible duplicate tea charge under lead review. Noor accepts both follow-ups.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Noor / dessert / open / tea

08

Outgoing server: "Table 8 needs a ¹ _____ follow-up."

Incoming server: "Table 9's check remains ² _____."

Outgoing server: "The queried item is ³ _____."

Incoming server: "The receiving server is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. dessert | 2. open | 3. tea | 4. Noor

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the answers and read the handover with a partner. Keep table four and table five's tasks separate.
2. Switch roles. Repeat Maya's two accepted follow-ups, preserving the shift lead's separate charge-review responsibility.
3. Complete the tea-charge transfer and check the key. Read Noor's handover without calling the query confirmed or the check paid.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The last salmon is spoken for

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Reconcile remaining portions, communicate an unavailable item, and obtain an actual replacement choice.

Fictional dinner service: four salmon portions remain, with three already committed to accepted tickets. Table 18 requests two more. The kitchen allocates the last available portion to one named guest after confirmation; the other chooses mushroom pasta at \$21 instead of salmon at \$26. There is no reported allergy.

PEOPLE / Nina: Server | Omar: Expeditor

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

09

WORD + PHRASE BANK

86 list / availability update / committed portions / price difference / replacement choice / substitution

- 01 **Nina:** Table eighteen wants two salmon. The board says four left, but I can see three salmon on accepted tickets. Is that four before those orders or four still available?
- 02 **Omar:** Four is the physical count, including the three ¹ _____. We have one available for a new order, not four.
- 03 **Nina:** Then I cannot promise both guests salmon. Please hold the table's new request while I explain the shortage and ask who would like the remaining portion.
- 04 **Omar:** Agreed. Once we allocate that last one, salmon goes on the ² _____. The existing three tickets still get theirs.
- 05 **Nina:** For the guests, I will say we have one salmon portion left. I will not tell them we have eighty-six salmon or use the shorthand without explaining.
- 06 **Omar:** Good. Tell them what is available and let them choose. Mushroom pasta is available at twenty-one dollars; salmon is twenty-six.
- 07 **Nina:** I have checked with table eighteen. Seat one wants the last salmon. Seat two has chosen the pasta after hearing both prices.
- 08 **Omar:** I have allocated the last salmon to seat one. Record the ³ _____ against seat two only, with the guest's confirmed choice.
- 09 **Nina:** That makes forty-seven dollars for those two mains, before any other bill items or applicable charges. It was fifty-two for two salmon.
- 10 **Omar:** Yes, a five-dollar ⁴ _____ for these mains. It is not a separate discount on top of the pasta's twenty-one-dollar price.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Nina:** I will enter the pasta at its own price, not leave a salmon charge and hope someone remembers to change it later.
- 12 **Omar:** Please read the updated ticket back to me before we proceed. I need the table, seats, dishes, and the fact that only seat two changed.
- 13 **Nina:** Table eighteen: seat one salmon, twenty-six; seat two mushroom pasta, twenty-one. The pasta is the ⁵ _____ the guest has agreed to.
- 14 **Omar:** Confirmed. I have the last salmon allocated. We now have zero available for additional orders, although four portions still physically await preparation.
- 15 **Nina:** I will tell the section team and ask the authorized person to update the ordering system. Should we also check the online menu?
- 16 **Omar:** Yes, verify each relevant ordering channel. Do not assume a handwritten board or one screen changes every listing, especially where items have separate records.
- 17 **Nina:** I will confirm the ⁶ _____ reached the floor and ordering channels. I will not remove salmon from the tickets already accepted.
- 18 **Omar:** Exactly. If another guest asks, offer the current alternatives and their prices. Do not promise a portion that belongs to one of these tickets.
- 19 **Nina:** Then the final read-back is three earlier salmon, one salmon for table eighteen seat one, and pasta for seat two. No salmon remains to sell.
- 20 **Omar:** That matches. Send the corrected table order through our process, and keep the stock message separate from the guest's individual change.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. committed portions | 2. 86 list | 3. substitution | 4. price difference | 5. replacement choice | 6. availability update

Count what can still be sold

F Say it in a new situation

Six sea-bass portions physically remain; four are committed to accepted tickets. Three new guests request sea bass. Two choose the available portions at \$28 each; the third agrees to \$24 chicken. Other bill items and charges are outside this comparison.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

two / unavailable / chicken / 80

09

Server: There are ¹ _____ portions available before the new choices.

Expositor: The third guest has agreed to ² _____ .

Server: These three mains total ³ _____ dollars.

Expositor: After allocation, sea bass is ⁴ _____ for further orders.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. two | 2. chicken | 3. 80 | 4. unavailable

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Service charge or optional tip?

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Explain an itemized charge and optional payment choice without making unsupported claims about tax or staff distribution.

Fictional US check: food and drinks subtotal \$150; disclosed mandatory service charge 18% of that subtotal, \$27; separately listed tax \$12. Total before any voluntary extra tip is \$189. The terminal offers an optional tip. No staff-distribution policy or general tax-rate rule is supplied.

PEOPLE / Dev: Guest reviewing the check | Alma: Server

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

distribution policy / subtotal / service charge / amount due / listed tax / additional gratuity

10

- 01 **Dev:** Could you explain these two lines? There is already a service charge on the bill, but the terminal is asking about a tip as well.
- 02 **Alma:** Of course. The ¹ _____ is the eighteen-percent charge shown in our terms. The extra tip on the terminal is optional.
- 03 **Dev:** Eighteen percent of which amount? I want to check the arithmetic because the tax is listed on a separate line.
- 04 **Alma:** The ² _____ for food and drinks is one hundred fifty dollars. Eighteen percent of that is twenty-seven dollars.
- 05 **Dev:** And the twelve dollars below it is tax already included in the total shown? It is not another amount I need to add myself?
- 06 **Alma:** Correct. One hundred fifty plus twenty-seven plus twelve gives the ³ _____ of one hundred eighty-nine, before any extra tip you choose.
- 07 **Dev:** I was worried the screen would add eighteen percent again. Does leaving the tip at zero remove the existing service charge?
- 08 **Alma:** No. Zero on the optional-tip screen means no ⁴ _____. The existing bill still totals one hundred eighty-nine.
- 09 **Dev:** I would like to pay that total without an extra tip today. I do not want to select a suggested percentage by mistake.
- 10 **Alma:** Certainly. Please use the no-extra-tip choice and check the amount displayed before confirming. I can explain the screen without selecting an amount for you.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Dev:** Thank you. Does the service charge go directly to you, or is it shared among the team?
- 12 **Alma:** I would need our manager to explain the actual ⁵ _____. I should not promise where every dollar goes without checking.
- 13 **Dev:** Please do ask. I am not trying to argue with you; I just want to understand what I am paying and what the staff receive.
- 14 **Alma:** I understand. The bill calculation and the distribution question are separate. I can show the first now and get the manager's answer to the second.
- 15 **Dev:** Is this how every restaurant calculates tax on service charges? I have seen different layouts on other bills.
- 16 **Alma:** No general tax rule follows from this check. The twelve dollars is the ⁶ _____ in our example. Applicable tax treatment and other restaurants' terms need their own verification.
- 17 **Dev:** All right. The calculation here is clear: one hundred fifty for the order, twenty-seven service charge, twelve tax. I am choosing no extra tip.
- 18 **Alma:** Yes. Please check that the terminal shows one hundred eighty-nine for your selected payment. Agreeing the amount does not itself complete the transaction.
- 19 **Dev:** It shows the amount we discussed. I will confirm it myself, and I would like an itemized receipt afterward.
- 20 **Alma:** Certainly. I will provide the receipt through our payment process and follow up with the manager on your distribution question. I will not treat that question as already answered.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. service charge | 2. subtotal | 3. amount due | 4. additional gratuity | 5. distribution policy | 6. listed tax

Explain a different check

F Say it in a new situation

A fictional check lists an \$80 subtotal, a mandatory 15% service charge on that subtotal, and \$6 listed tax. The guest chooses no additional tip. No staff-distribution percentage or universal tax rule is supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

zero / 12 / unspecified / 98

10

Guest: The service charge is ¹ _____ dollars.

Server: The total before any extra tip is ² _____ dollars.

Guest: My additional tip choice is ³ _____ .

Server: The staff-distribution policy remains ⁴ _____ .

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. 12 | 2. 98 | 3. zero | 4. unspecified

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.

2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.

3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Read the menu, keep the choice

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Offer useful menu access, communicate prices and ingredients precisely, and address the guest directly.

Guest Rosa has low vision and asks server Theo to read the two vegetarian mains with prices. The current menu lists mushroom risotto \$22 with Parmesan, and chickpea stew \$20 with bread. Rosa chooses the stew and asks to keep the bread. No vegan request or allergy is reported.

PEOPLE / Rosa: Guest choosing a main | Theo: Server

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

choice / format / Parmesan / read back / chickpea stew / itemized bill

11

- 01 **Rosa:** Could you read the vegetarian mains to me, including the prices? I cannot read this print comfortably, and the menu on my phone is not opening.
- 02 **Theo:** Certainly. Would you like just that section first, or would another
1 _____ work better for you?
- 03 **Rosa:** Reading that section would be helpful. Please tell me what comes with each dish, not only the names.
- 04 **Theo:** There are two listed options. The mushroom risotto is twenty-two dollars and includes
2 _____. The chickpea stew is twenty dollars and comes with bread.
- 05 **Rosa:** Could you repeat the stew price? I heard the two dishes, but missed the second amount when someone passed behind me.
- 06 **Theo:** The 3 _____ is twenty dollars, including bread. The risotto is twenty-two.
- 07 **Rosa:** Thank you. I will have the stew. Please keep the bread; I do not need anything taken off.
- 08 **Theo:** Stew with bread as listed. Is that the 4 _____ you would like me to enter?
- 09 **Rosa:** Yes. My friend may order something different, so please keep our choices separate.
- 10 **Theo:** Of course. I will take each order directly. Would you like me to read the drinks section too?

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Rosa:** Not yet. I will stay with water for now. Thank you for asking rather than working through the whole menu while I am deciding.
- 12 **Theo:** You are welcome. I will ⁵ _____ your order before sending it: chickpea stew with bread, twenty dollars; water for now.
- 13 **Rosa:** That is correct. Is the twenty dollars the price of the stew, or have you included anything else in that figure?
- 14 **Theo:** It is the menu price for the stew with bread. I have not represented it as the final bill total with every possible charge included.
- 15 **Rosa:** Good. When the check comes, could you read the items and total to me as well? I want to check it myself.
- 16 **Theo:** Certainly. We can review the ⁶ _____ and total together using a method that works for you.
- 17 **Rosa:** One more thing: my companion does not need to answer for me. I may ask for help reading, but I can make my own order.
- 18 **Theo:** Understood. I will speak directly with you and ask what assistance is useful. I will not treat help with print as permission to make your choices.
- 19 **Rosa:** Thank you. Then I am ready to order the stew with bread. Please let me know if anything in that description has changed.
- 20 **Theo:** I will check any changed detail rather than silently substitute. Your selected order is clear, and I will follow our normal ordering process.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. format | 2. Parmesan | 3. chickpea stew | 4. choice | 5. read back | 6. itemized bill

Read the requested section accurately

F Say it in a new situation

Guest Jo asks for the two desserts and prices to be read aloud. The menu lists apple crumble \$8 with vanilla ice cream, and mango sorbet \$7. Jo chooses the sorbet. No allergy or dietary restriction is reported.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

ice cream / 8 / 7 / sorbet

Server: The crumble costs ¹ _____ dollars.

Guest: The crumble comes with vanilla ² _____ .

Server: Your chosen dessert is mango ³ _____ .

Guest: Its menu price is ⁴ _____ dollars.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. 8 | 2. ice cream | 3. sorbet | 4. 7

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.

2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.

3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Confirming seats and order details

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. Which seat has not chosen?

C. Seat three

The brief explicitly leaves seat three's dish undecided.

2. Which request already belongs to the salad?

B. Dressing separately

Seat two requested salad with the dressing served separately.

3. What did Lena need to clarify when she first heard the request?

D. Which dish should have no onions

The onion request initially lacked a dish reference; Sam subsequently attached it to the salad.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which clarification is most useful?

A. Which dish should have no onions?

The question asks for the missing dish reference without blame or unsupported changes.

2. What should be sent as the salad modifier after Sam confirms?

D. No onions, dressing on the side

Sam confirms the onion request for the salad, which already has separate dressing.

3. Which statement preserves the pending choice?

D. Seat three is still deciding.

The brief leaves the third choice open rather than establishing a dish or cancellation.

4. What does the onion request establish medically?

A. No allergy diagnosis or report by itself

A requested omission alone does not supply an allergy report or a safety conclusion.

01 Conversation answers

Confirming seats and order details

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. modifier. Turn 2. The modifier changes the salad order; Lena has confirmed that the onion request belongs to Sam at seat two.

2. on the side. Turn 4. On the side means the dressing is served separately, as Sam requested for the salad.

3. pending choice. Turn 6. Seat three has not selected a dish; a pending choice is neither a cancellation nor an order.

4. read-back. Turn 8. A read-back repeats the recorded details so the colleagues can catch an error before transmission.

5. seat reference. Turn 10. The seat reference attaches both salad requests to seat two and leaves seat one's pasta unchanged.

6. order ticket. Turn 12. The order ticket communicates preparation instructions; its modifiers must stay with the correct dish when sent.

7. covers. Turn 14. Covers counts diners; three diners does not establish three completed main-course orders.

8. omission. Turn 16. The omission is removal of onions from the salad; no allergy has been reported in this case.

9. confirmation. Turn 18. Confirmation checks the actual chosen dish and details; the unfinished third choice cannot be confirmed in advance.

10. send the order. Turn 20. Send the order means transmit the checked details, after resolving the remaining choice through the restaurant's process.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. fish

Server: "The lemon request belongs to the fish."

The clarification specifically attaches the separate lemon to the grilled fish.

2. two

Guest: "That is seat two."

The guest ordering grilled fish is in seat two.

3. unchanged

Server: "The tomato soup remains unchanged."

No modification to the soup is supplied in the facts.

4. covers

Guest: "There are two covers."

Covers counts diners, and this table has two diners.

02 Briefing and language checks

Explaining menu choices and prices

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What is the steak set price?

D. \$29

The \$24 base plus the \$5 steak supplement equals \$29.

2. Which item is included in both steak options?

B. Potatoes

Both the steak set and a la carte steak include potatoes.

3. What is not supplied?

D. A separate dessert price

The case gives the set comparison, not a standalone dessert price.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which calculation is correct?

B. \$24 + \$5 = \$29 for the steak set

The supplement is added to the set base, not to the a la carte price.

2. Which comparison is complete?

D. \$29 with dessert versus \$27 without dessert; both include potatoes.

This comparison gives the actual prices and distinguishes shared and different inclusions.

3. What cannot be inferred from the two-dollar difference?

B. The restaurant's standalone dessert price is \$2.

A difference between bundled offers does not establish the separate selling price of a component.

4. Which recommendation avoids pressure?

B. If you want dessert, the set includes it for two dollars more than steak alone.

The recommendation uses the supplied price and inclusion difference without inventing benefits or removing choice.

02 Conversation answers

Explaining menu choices and prices

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. base price.** Turn 2. The base price is the set's starting amount before the listed five-dollar steak supplement is added.
- 2. supplement.** Turn 4. A supplement is an addition to the stated base, not a replacement price or the cost of the whole dish.
- 3. a la carte.** Turn 6. A la carte identifies an individual menu item rather than the main-and-dessert set being compared.
- 4. inclusion.** Turn 8. An inclusion is covered by the quoted option; potatoes are included in both steak choices in this menu.
- 5. price difference.** Turn 10. The price difference is twenty-nine minus twenty-seven, or two dollars between these two specific options.
- 6. standalone price.** Turn 12. The standalone price applies to a dessert bought separately; the two-dollar bundle difference does not establish it.
- 7. value comparison.** Turn 14. A value comparison considers both price and inclusions, allowing the guest to decide whether the dessert matters.
- 8. main-and-dessert set.** Turn 16. The main-and-dessert set names the included courses; coffee is not supplied as an inclusion in this comparison.
- 9. price basis.** Turn 18. The price basis specifies what each quoted amount covers, avoiding unsupported claims about other items or charges.
- 10. guest choice.** Turn 20. The guest choice must be confirmed explicitly; discussing an option at length does not authorize ordering it.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. twenty-four

Server: "The fish set costs twenty-four dollars."

Twenty dollars plus the four-dollar supplement equals twenty-four dollars.

2. twenty-two

Guest: "Fish alone is twenty-two dollars."

The stated a la carte price is twenty-two dollars without dessert.

3. rice

Server: "Both options include rice."

Rice is included in both options under the supplied menu.

4. unspecified

Guest: "The separate dessert price is unspecified."

The bundle comparison does not supply a standalone dessert price.

03 Briefing and language checks

Receiving an allergy question

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. Which allergen does Eli report?

D. Sesame

Eli explicitly reports a sesame allergy in the brief.

2. What information does Noor hold?

A. An old menu description

The available description is old and does not establish current ingredients or handling.

3. Who is available before an order is sent?

D. Kitchen lead Cam

Cam is identified as available to discuss the allergy question.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which first response is best?

B. Thank you for telling me; I will check the current bun and handling information with Cam.

The response acknowledges the allergy and directs the unresolved questions to current product and preparation checks.

2. Which distinction matters?

B. Ingredients and cross-contact are separate questions.

A product's intended ingredients do not alone answer how unintended allergen contact is managed.

3. What does Cam's availability establish?

A. A kitchen lead can discuss the query.

Availability provides a responsible contact, not a completed product or preparation assessment.

4. Which guest update is accurate?

D. I cannot confirm suitability yet; the current information is being checked.

The update preserves the unresolved status without offering a false guarantee or inventing a clinical event.

03 Conversation answers

Receiving an allergy question

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

1. reported allergen. Turn 2. The reported allergen is sesame, which must be communicated accurately rather than replaced by a vague dietary note.

2. current product. Turn 4. The current product is the bun actually used today; an old description cannot establish its present ingredients.

3. cross-contact. Turn 6. Cross-contact concerns unintended allergen introduction, which is not answered solely by the bun's intended ingredient list.

4. ingredient list. Turn 8. The ingredient list must match the actual bun in use, rather than an older menu or another supplied product.

5. handling information. Turn 10. Handling information covers preparation and service conditions, making it distinct from the list of intentional ingredients.

6. product specification. Turn 12. The product specification describes the supplied item; visual appearance alone is not equivalent to verified product information.

7. order hold. Turn 14. The order hold prevents this unresolved allergy query from being treated as an ordinary confirmed order ready for preparation.

8. ingredient verification. Turn 16. Ingredient verification is the actual check of the relevant product; receiving the question does not mean that check is complete.

9. alternative dish. Turn 18. An alternative dish is a separate option requiring appropriate checks, not an automatically safe replacement for the bun.

10. allergy flag. Turn 20. The allergy flag preserves the reported sesame allergy with the relevant order and handoff; it does not itself certify suitability.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. peanut

Server: "The reported allergen is peanut."

Alex reports peanut, which must be repeated without changing the allergen.

2. sauce

Colleague: "The product being questioned is the sauce."

The inquiry concerns the sauce, not an invented bread or dessert.

3. Imani

Server: "The receiving kitchen lead is Imani."

Imani explicitly accepts the query as the named kitchen lead.

4. confirmed

Colleague: "Suitability is not yet confirmed."

Neither current ingredients nor handling has been verified in this exchange.

04 Briefing and language checks

Coordinating courses and delays

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. When were the mains fired?

D. 7:20

The kitchen began the relevant preparation stage at the stated 7:20 time.

2. What is the current estimate at 7:30?

B. Another eight minutes

The estimate is eight additional minutes from the 7:30 update.

3. What is the guests' departure requirement?

C. Leave at 7:50

The guests explicitly need to leave at 7:50.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which timing explanation is accurate?

B. At 7:30 the kitchen estimates eight more minutes, pointing to around 7:38.

The explanation anchors the additional eight minutes to the current update and retains uncertainty.

2. What does 7:50 minus 7:38 establish?

D. A twelve-minute clock interval, not guaranteed dining time

Arithmetic alone does not establish delivery, eating, payment, or a comfortable departure.

3. Which offer stays within the facts?

A. I can discuss the timing options with you and the kitchen.

A timing discussion is available without inventing an approved operational or financial change.

4. Which phrase needs translation for a guest?

B. Your mains were fired at 7:20.

Fired is internal kitchen shorthand and may need a plain-language explanation of the preparation stage.

04 Conversation answers

Coordinating courses and delays

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. readiness estimate.** Turn 2. The readiness estimate is provisional information about food readiness, not a promise that the whole meal will finish on time.
- 2. remaining time.** Turn 4. Remaining time means additional time from the seven-thirty update, not total time since preparation began.
- 3. fired time.** Turn 6. The fired time records the preparation instruction at seven twenty; it is distinct from the later readiness estimate.
- 4. departure deadline.** Turn 8. The departure deadline is seven fifty, which must be considered separately from preparation or service estimates.
- 5. rush request.** Turn 10. A rush request asks for acceleration; it does not establish accepted priority or a faster confirmed completion time.
- 6. timing discussion.** Turn 12. A timing discussion explores feasible options without claiming that a substitute or cancellation has already been approved.
- 7. table update.** Turn 14. A table update should communicate the actual order status and options, not repeat reassurance unsupported by the kitchen.
- 8. Pickup.** Turn 16. Pickup is the kitchen-to-service handoff, which remains distinct from delivery to the table and completion of the meal.
- 9. timing constraint.** Turn 18. The timing constraint remains the guests' seven-fifty departure; an uncertain kitchen estimate does not remove it.
- 10. completion promise.** Turn 20. A completion promise would commit to a finished outcome; the available estimate does not justify such a guarantee.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. 8:10

Server: "The estimate starts from 8:10."

The additional six minutes is anchored to the 8:10 update.

2. 8:16

Guest: "That points to around 8:16."

Adding six minutes to 8:10 produces the approximate 8:16 time.

3. 8:30

Server: "Your departure requirement is 8:30."

The supplied deadline is departure at 8:30, not food readiness.

4. unconfirmed

Guest: "A faster alternative remains unconfirmed."

No quicker option has been confirmed in this scenario.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Correcting a dish without blame

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What does the ticket confirm?

B. Vegetable pasta

The ticket supports the guest's vegetable-pasta order rather than the dish delivered.

2. What replacement can Dana offer?

B. A pasta remake with an estimated ten-minute wait

The kitchen offers the pasta remake, with its timing stated as an estimate.

3. Who must review a bill adjustment?

B. The shift lead

The case assigns bill-adjustment review to the shift lead.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which apology fits the facts?

A. I am sorry; the ticket confirms pasta, but we brought risotto.

The apology acknowledges the confirmed mismatch without blaming the guest or inventing a cause.

2. Which offer is authorized?

D. A pasta remake with an estimated ten-minute wait

Dana may offer the remake, while timing remains estimated and billing requires review.

3. Which statement keeps the financial decision accurate?

A. I will ask the shift lead to review the bill question.

The supplied authority covers referral for review, not a completed adjustment or universal rule.

4. When can the issue be described as fully resolved?

C. After the relevant agreed actions are actually completed and checked

An apology and offer are steps toward resolution, not evidence that the correction and related decisions are complete.

05 Conversation answers

Correcting a dish without blame

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

- 1. mistake.** Turn 2. The ticket confirms pasta but risotto arrived, so mistake acknowledges an established service error without assigning blame.
- 2. remake.** Turn 4. A remake is a newly prepared corrected dish, here the vegetable pasta originally ordered.
- 3. estimated wait.** Turn 6. An estimated wait is approximate; Dana cannot turn the kitchen's estimate into a guaranteed arrival time.
- 4. bill adjustment.** Turn 8. A bill adjustment changes the charge and requires the shift lead's review under this case's stated authority.
- 5. complimentary.** Turn 10. Complimentary means provided without charge; the offered remake has not been approved as free.
- 6. cause.** Turn 12. Cause concerns how the delivery error happened; the correct ticket alone does not identify the responsible stage or person.
- 7. check back.** Turn 14. Check back means return to verify the correction and update the guest if the timing changes.
- 8. go-ahead.** Turn 16. The go-ahead is the guest's permission to proceed; Alex has expressly asked Dana not to start the remake yet.
- 9. shift lead.** Turn 18. The shift lead reviews the charge question and can receive Alex's request for a direct conversation.
- 10. next step.** Turn 20. The next step is the bill review and update; neither the financial decision nor Alex's remake choice is complete.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. lentil

Server: "The ticket confirms lentil soup."

Lentil is the ordered soup confirmed by the ticket.

2. tomato

Guest: "The delivered soup was tomato."

Tomato is the soup actually delivered in this scenario.

3. seven

Server: "The estimated remake wait is seven minutes."

Seven minutes is the stated estimate, not a guaranteed arrival time.

4. Noor

Guest: "The bill question goes to Noor."

Noor is named as the lead responsible for reviewing an adjustment.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Explaining and splitting a bill

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What is the stated bill total?

A. \$72 with all listed charges included

The scenario supplies a seventy-two-dollar total with its listed charges already included.

2. What does three ways need to clarify?

A. Equal payments or separate checks by item

The phrase can refer to different allocation methods even with three diners.

3. What is each equal share?

D. \$24

Seventy-two divided by three equals twenty-four dollars per equal share.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which first question resolves the ambiguity?

B. Do you mean equal payments or separate checks by item?

The question presents the two supported methods without guessing the group's intention.

2. Which arithmetic is correct for equal shares?

D. \$72 divided by 3 is \$24 each.

Three times twenty-four equals the full seventy-two-dollar total.

3. What is needed to calculate item-based checks?

A. An agreed allocation of items and shared charges

Item-based amounts depend on who is assigned each charge, not simply the diner count.

4. What does confirmation of three equal payments establish?

D. The intended allocation, not completed payment

Agreeing the method precedes processing and does not prove that any payment has been completed.

06 Conversation answers

Explaining and splitting a bill

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. equal shares.** Turn 2. Equal shares divide the total into the same amount for each diner, unlike separate checks based on individual items.
- 2. bill total.** Turn 4. The bill total is the stated seventy-two dollars, including all listed charges in this fictional scenario.
- 3. item allocation.** Turn 6. Item allocation assigns charges to the relevant diners; their amounts cannot be calculated from the diner count alone.
- 4. allocation method.** Turn 8. The allocation method is the group's agreed way of dividing the bill, which the server should not choose for them.
- 5. split payment.** Turn 10. The split payment applies three agreed twenty-four-dollar payments to one seventy-two-dollar bill; it does not change the total.
- 6. card terminal.** Turn 12. The card terminal displays the payment being submitted; checking its amount helps prevent an incorrect full-bill charge.
- 7. listed charge.** Turn 14. A listed charge is already part of the supplied total; splitting the payment does not justify charging it a second time.
- 8. payment receipt.** Turn 16. A payment receipt records an actual transaction; it should not be represented as proof of payment before processing occurs.
- 9. outstanding balance.** Turn 18. The outstanding balance is what remains unpaid after actual recorded payments, not an amount inferred solely from the agreed split.
- 10. payment confirmation.** Turn 20. Payment confirmation establishes the relevant completed transaction status, which remains separate from agreeing a payment plan.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. equal

Server: "You have chosen equal payments."

The diners explicitly choose equal payments rather than item-based checks.

2. twenty-four

Guest: "Each share is twenty-four dollars."

Ninety-six divided by four equals twenty-four dollars per diner.

3. ninety-six

Server: "The full total remains ninety-six dollars."

Changing the allocation does not change the stated ninety-six-dollar total.

4. processed

Guest: "The payments are not yet processed."

The scenario confirms the method but supplies no completed payment.

07 Briefing and language checks

Agreeing on clearing and shared service

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. Why is the empty plate still needed?

C. The diner is using it for another portion.

The brief states that the diner will use the plate for more shared food.

2. What remains in the shared dish?

B. Vegetables

The shared vegetable dish still contains food in this case.

3. What may the team offer?

B. Extra sharing plates

Extra sharing plates are available to offer, while clearing still needs clarification.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which question is most appropriate?

D. May I clear this plate, or are you still using it?

The question checks the actual plate and allows the diner to keep using it.

2. What does the empty plate establish?

B. Its current contents, not that it is no longer needed

The plate is empty but remains in use for another portion.

3. Which instruction should Mina give Leo?

C. Leave the active plate and ask what may be cleared.

The instruction preserves active items while allowing a specific clearing-permission check.

4. How should cultural differences be handled?

D. Ask the individual table about its preference.

A direct, respectful question establishes the actual preference without relying on group stereotypes.

07 Conversation answers

Agreeing on clearing and shared service

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. active item. Turn 2. The active item is the empty plate still needed for another portion; its empty surface does not make it finished.

2. service cue. Turn 4. A service cue may suggest a need, but the empty plate is ambiguous and requires checking with the guest.

3. clearing permission. Turn 6. Clearing permission is the guest's agreement to remove the specific item, which should be obtained before taking it.

4. guest preference. Turn 8. The guest preference is the actual table's request, not a rule inferred from nationality or an empty plate.

5. sharing plate. Turn 10. A sharing plate can help guests take portions from a shared dish, but the extra item remains an offer.

6. shared dish. Turn 12. The shared dish still contains vegetables for continued service, so one empty individual plate does not establish permission to remove it.

7. finished item. Turn 14. A finished item can be removed with appropriate agreement without treating the entire table as finished with the meal.

8. table reset. Turn 16. A table reset prepares the setting for new guests; clearing one agreed item during a meal is a different stage.

9. meal pace. Turn 18. Meal pace is the guests' eating rhythm, which the team can respect by checking needs instead of rushing active items away.

10. Unobtrusive service. Turn 20. Unobtrusive service meets the real need with minimal disruption, combining a specific question with respectful follow-through.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. needed

Server: "The empty plate is still needed."

The diner needs the plate for another portion of shared dessert.

2. dessert

Colleague: "The shared dish contains dessert."

The remaining food in the supplied shared dish is dessert.

3. offered

Server: "Extra small plates can be offered."

The plates are an available offer, not an automatic addition.

4. given

Colleague: "Clearing permission has not been given."

The scenario supplies no guest permission to remove the active plate.

08 Briefing and language checks

Handing over a live section

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What is table 4's meal stage?

C. Mains served; dessert not ordered

The brief states that the mains are served while dessert remains unchosen.

2. What is table 5's check status?

B. Open

Table 5 has an open check while the coffee query remains under review.

3. Who is reviewing the possible duplicate coffee charge?

C. The shift lead

The shift lead is already reviewing the query, but no result is supplied.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which handover for table 4 is correct?

C. Mains served; dessert not ordered; follow up the dessert choice.

The message preserves the known meal stage and identifies the unfinished dessert follow-up.

2. Which coffee description is justified?

C. A possible duplicate charge under shift-lead review

The brief supplies a pending query, not a confirmed error, motive, or adjustment.

3. Which ownership arrangement is clear?

C. Maya accepts guest follow-up while the shift lead reviews the charge.

The arrangement distinguishes guest communication from the decision authority and gives both work streams an owner.

4. What must precede calling table 5's check closed?

A. The actual relevant payment and closure process

A staffing handover does not establish that the bill has been paid or closed.

08 Conversation answers

Handing over a live section

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. handover.** Turn 2. The handover transfers relevant table information and accepted responsibility, not just a list of numbers.
- 2. mains served.** Turn 4. Mains served means the main dishes have reached table four; it does not establish that dessert has been ordered.
- 3. dessert decision.** Turn 6. The dessert decision is the guest's pending choice; the incoming server should ask rather than treat it as an existing order.
- 4. open check.** Turn 8. The open check remains unsettled in the relevant process; the handover does not supply payment or closure.
- 5. suspected duplicate.** Turn 10. A suspected duplicate is a possible repeated charge under review, not a confirmed error or approved adjustment.
- 6. service owner.** Turn 12. The service owner takes responsibility for guest-facing follow-up while the shift lead remains responsible for the charge decision.
- 7. exception note.** Turn 14. The exception note preserves the unusual unresolved coffee query alongside the table's ordinary service and payment status.
- 8. read-back confirmation.** Turn 16. Read-back confirmation checks that the receiving server has matched each table with the correct unfinished task.
- 9. status change.** Turn 18. A status change must reflect an actual new event or decision, not an assumption caused by the handover.
- 10. continuity of service.** Turn 20. Continuity of service keeps guest needs attended to across the staffing change without losing unresolved work.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. dessert

Outgoing server: "Table 8 needs a dessert follow-up."

Dessert is not ordered, so Noor needs to check that choice.

2. open

Incoming server: "Table 9's check remains open."

No payment or closure is established for table nine.

3. tea

Outgoing server: "The queried item is tea."

The possible duplicate concerns tea rather than an invented coffee charge.

4. Noor

Incoming server: "The receiving server is Noor."

Noor explicitly accepts both follow-ups in this handover.

08

09 Conversation answers

The last salmon is spoken for

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. committed portions. Turn 2. Three of the four physical portions already belong to accepted tickets, leaving only one for a new order.

2. 86 list. Turn 4. The 86 list identifies items unavailable for further orders; it does not cancel portions already committed to accepted tickets.

3. substitution. Turn 8. The substitution replaces seat two's requested salmon with the pasta that the guest actually selected.

4. price difference. Turn 10. Two salmon would total \$52; one \$26 salmon plus \$21 pasta totals \$47, a \$5 difference for these mains.

5. replacement choice. Turn 13. Seat two explicitly chose mushroom pasta after the shortage and price were explained; it is not a kitchen-selected substitute.

6. availability update. Turn 17. The availability update must communicate that no further salmon orders can be accepted; existing committed orders remain distinct.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. two

Server: There are two portions available before the new choices.

Six physical portions minus four already committed leaves two available to allocate.

2. chicken

Expeditor: The third guest has agreed to chicken .

The replacement is explicitly chosen chicken, not a substitute selected without permission.

3. 80

Server: These three mains total 80 dollars.

Two sea-bass mains at \$28 plus chicken at \$24 equals \$80.

4. unavailable

Expeditor: After allocation, sea bass is unavailable for further orders.

All six physical portions are now committed; physical presence does not mean they remain available to sell.

Background reading: [Toast: menu-item inventory and 86 status](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

10 Conversation answers

Service charge or optional tip?

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

1. service charge. Turn 2. The \$27 service charge is mandatory under this fictional restaurant's disclosed terms, unlike an additional voluntary tip.

2. subtotal. Turn 4. The stated \$150 food-and-drinks subtotal is the basis for this charge; the example does not apply eighteen percent to the final total.

3. amount due. Turn 6. The supplied amounts sum to \$189 before a voluntary extra tip; the already listed tax and service charge must not be added again.

4. additional gratuity. Turn 8. An additional gratuity is a voluntary extra amount; selecting zero there does not remove the existing mandatory service charge.

5. distribution policy. Turn 12. The case supplies no policy explaining how the service charge is distributed; Alma must not invent a staff share.

6. listed tax. Turn 16. The case supplies a \$12 tax line, not a universal rate or rule about which charges are taxable.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

1. 12

Guest: The service charge is 12 dollars.

Fifteen percent of the \$80 subtotal is \$12, not fifteen percent of the final total.

2. 98

Server: The total before any extra tip is 98 dollars.

The \$80 subtotal plus \$12 service charge plus \$6 listed tax equals \$98.

3. zero

Guest: My additional tip choice is zero .

The guest explicitly chooses no extra tip; that does not cancel the mandatory service charge.

4. unspecified

Server: The staff-distribution policy remains unspecified .

The check's arithmetic gives no evidence of what proportion is paid to staff.

10

Background reading: [IRS: voluntary tips and mandatory service charges](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

11 Conversation answers

Read the menu, keep the choice

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

- 1. format.** Turn 2. Format describes how the menu information is presented; Theo asks what works instead of assuming the phone or print is accessible.
- 2. Parmesan.** Turn 4. Parmesan is the explicitly listed risotto ingredient; omitting it would withhold relevant menu information from Rosa.
- 3. chickpea stew.** Turn 6. Chickpea stew is the second listed main, priced at \$20 and served with bread.
- 4. choice.** Turn 8. Rosa explicitly selects the stew with its bread; Theo confirms the guest's own decision rather than choosing for her.
- 5. read back.** Turn 12. Read back means repeat the selected order aloud so Rosa can check it without depending on the printed menu.
- 6. itemized bill.** Turn 16. An itemized bill separates the ordered items and listed charges; reading it lets Rosa review the bill herself.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

- 1. 8**
Server: The crumble costs 8 dollars.
Eight dollars is the stated crumble price, not the price of the sorbet.
- 2. ice cream**
Guest: The crumble comes with vanilla ice cream .
Vanilla ice cream is a listed accompaniment that should not be omitted from the spoken description.
- 3. sorbet**
Server: Your chosen dessert is mango sorbet .
Jo selects sorbet; assistance with reading does not transfer the choice to the server.
- 4. 7**
Guest: Its menu price is 7 dollars.
The sorbet's stated menu price is \$7; the facts do not establish the final bill total.

11

Background reading: [US Department of Justice: effective communication, including menu access](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Confirming seats and order details

Clarify the dish: Which dish should have no onions?

Read back seat two: Seat two is the salad with dressing on the side.

Ask briefly: May I check one detail before I send this?

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Explaining menu choices and prices

Introduce the set: The lunch set includes a main and dessert.

Give the combined price: That makes the steak set \$29.

Calculate the difference: The set is two dollars more than steak alone.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Receiving an allergy question

Acknowledge the disclosure: Thank you for telling me about the sesame allergy.

Pause the order: I will check before sending an order.

Include handling: We also need the relevant cross-contact information.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Coordinating courses and delays

Acknowledge the wait: I am sorry your mains are taking longer than you expected.

Translate the estimate: That points to around 7:38, not a guaranteed service time.

Separate stages: Kitchen readiness and arrival at the table are different stages.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Correcting a dish without blame

Acknowledge the mismatch: You ordered vegetable pasta, and we brought mushroom risotto.

Avoid blaming the guest: You do not need to explain the order again.

Keep timing honest: I cannot guarantee an exact arrival time.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Explaining and splitting a bill

Clarify the request: Do you mean three equal payments or separate checks by item?

Explain the other method: For item-based checks, I need to know which items belong to each person.

Confirm the selected method: You would like three equal payments, correct?

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Agreeing on clearing and shared service

Ask about an item: May I clear this plate, or are you still using it?

Offer practical help: Would extra sharing plates be useful?

Keep the question narrow: Ask about the specific item rather than the whole meal.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Handing over a live section

Open the transfer: It is 8:00, and I am handing over tables 4 and 5.

Name the first follow-up: Please check whether table 4 wants dessert.

Name the decision owner: The shift lead is reviewing the charge query.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

a la carte order a la carte	14
acceptance confirm acceptance	42
accepted follow-up record an accepted follow-up	69
accompaniment describe the accompaniment	6
active item leave active items	60
additional charge identify an additional charge	15
allergen identify the allergen	23
allergen matrix consult the current allergen matrix	23
allergic reaction follow allergic-reaction procedures	24
allergy flag enter an allergy flag	24
allocation method clarify the allocation method	50
alternative dish check an alternative dish	24
apology offer a clear apology	41
approval limit observe an approval limit	42
authorization check payment authorization	51
availability check availability	15
base price state the base price	14
bill adjustment request a bill adjustment	42
bill total confirm the bill total	50
blame avoid unsupported blame	41
bottleneck identify the bottleneck	33
busser coordinate with the busser	59
card terminal present the card terminal	51
cause avoid guessing the cause	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

charge review request a charge review	69
check bring the check	50
clear ask before clearing	59
clearing permission obtain clearing permission	60
closed check verify a closed check	69
comp obtain approval for a comp	42
completion promise avoid an unsupported completion promise	33
confirmation obtain confirmation	6
confirmed mismatch state the confirmed mismatch	41
contingency verify a contingency	33
continuity of service maintain continuity of service	69
coordinated service arrange coordinated service	33
course enter the main course	6
course pacing adjust course pacing	32
cover serve three covers	5
crockery handle the crockery	60
cross-contact assess allergen cross-contact	23
current product identify the current product	23
cutlery replace the cutlery	59
daily special explain the daily special	15
decision owner identify the decision owner	69
delivered dish identify the delivered dish	41
departure deadline acknowledge the departure deadline	32
dessert decision follow up the dessert decision	68

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

dietary requirement clarify a dietary requirement	6
discount authorize a discount	42
duplicate charge investigate a duplicate charge	51
elapsed time calculate elapsed time	33
emergency response activate the emergency response	24
equal share calculate an equal share	50
estimated wait explain the estimated wait	42
exception note preserve an exception note	69
exclusion clarify an exclusion	14
expeditor check with the expeditor	32
finished item identify finished items	60
fire fire the mains	32
fired time confirm the fired time	32
flatware provide clean flatware	60
follow-through ensure follow-through	69
follow-up check make a follow-up check	42
food allergy report a food allergy	23
food runner brief the food runner	59
garnish identify the garnish	6
glassware collect finished glassware	60
gratuity clarify a gratuity	51
guest choice confirm the guest choice	15
guest preference confirm the guest preference	60
handling information obtain handling information	24

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

handover complete the section handover	68
handover gap prevent a handover gap	69
handover time state the handover time	68
inclusion compare the inclusions	14
inclusive price explain the inclusive price	14
incoming server confirm the incoming server	68
inconvenience acknowledge the inconvenience	41
ingredient list check the current ingredient list	23
ingredient verification complete ingredient verification	24
item allocation confirm the item allocation	50
itemized bill review the itemized bill	50
itemized total present an itemized total	15
kitchen lead consult the kitchen lead	24
listed charge verify a listed charge	50
live table identify live tables	68
main choose a main	6
main-and-dessert set choose the main-and-dessert set	14
mains served confirm mains served	68
meal pace respect the meal pace	60
menu description read the menu description	15
menu pairing explain the menu pairing	15
modifier attach a modifier	5
omission confirm the omission	5
on the fly request a dish on the fly	33

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

on the side serve dressing on the side	5
open check monitor the open check	68
optional extra describe an optional extra	15
order hold maintain the order hold	24
order mismatch acknowledge the order mismatch	41
order pad update the order pad	5
order sequence preserve the order sequence	6
order ticket read the order ticket	5
ordered dish confirm the ordered dish	41
outgoing server brief the outgoing server	68
outstanding balance confirm the outstanding balance	51
partial payment record a partial payment	51
pass collect from the pass	32
payment confirmation check payment confirmation	51
payment method confirm the payment method	51
payment receipt provide a payment receipt	51
pending choice keep a choice pending	6
pending query carry forward a pending query	68
pickup coordinate pickup	32
place setting maintain the place setting	59
point of sale enter the order at the point of sale	5
portion describe the portion	15
pre-bus pre-bus discreetly	59
preference record a preference	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

preparation area verify the preparation area	23
preparation request confirm the preparation request	6
preparation stage confirm the preparation stage	32
price basis state the price basis	15
price clarification give a price clarification	15
price difference calculate the price difference	14
priority confirm priority	33
product specification verify the product specification	23
product substitution check for a product substitution	24
read-back give a read-back	5
read-back confirmation obtain read-back confirmation	69
readiness estimate give a readiness estimate	32
recipe check the current recipe	23
recipe change verify a recipe change	24
reconciliation complete payment reconciliation	51
refund process an approved refund	42
remaining time state the remaining time	32
remake request a remake	41
remedy offer an available remedy	42
replacement offer explain the replacement offer	41
reported allergen repeat the reported allergen	24
resolution status confirm the resolution status	42
rounding explain rounding	51
rush request check a rush request	33

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

seat number confirm the seat number	5
seat reference clarify the seat reference	5
section take over a section	68
send the order send the order	6
separate check prepare separate checks	50
service charge explain a service charge	50
service cue clarify a service cue	60
service owner name the service owner	69
service recovery manage service recovery	41
service station organize the service station	59
service window discuss the service window	32
serving utensil provide a serving utensil	59
sesame flag a sesame allergy	23
set menu explain the set menu	14
settle the bill settle the bill	51
shared dish leave the shared dish	59
shared equipment check shared equipment	23
shared item allocate a shared item	50
sharing plate offer a sharing plate	59
shift lead consult the shift lead	42
side dish include a side dish	14
side plate offer a side plate	59
sideboard restock the sideboard	59
split payment arrange a split payment	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

standalone price	verify the standalone price	14
starter	order a starter	6
status change	communicate a status change	69
substitution	check a substitution	5
subtotal	distinguish the subtotal	50
supplement	apply the steak supplement	14
supplier label	inspect the supplier label	23
suspected duplicate	review a suspected duplicate	68
table number	check the table number	5
table reset	begin an authorized table reset	60
table status	summarize the table status	68
table turnover	manage table turnover	60
table update	deliver a table update	33
ticket check	perform a ticket check	41
ticket time	check the ticket time	32
timing constraint	clarify the timing constraint	33
timing discussion	offer a timing discussion	33
unobtrusive service	provide unobtrusive service	60
unresolved item	track the unresolved item	69
unsupported assurance	avoid an unsupported assurance	24
update point	agree an update point	33
upgrade	explain the upgrade	14
value comparison	make a value comparison	15
void	record an authorized void	42

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Waiters and Waitresses.

[Open the original source](#)

Occupational context for order-taking, kitchen communication, guest service, clearing, and payment work. The original cases do not represent employment statistics. Checked 10 October 2026.

[2] US Food and Drug Administration. Food Allergies.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for allergen and cross-contact terminology. The allergy dialogue never certifies a dish or substitutes for current ingredient and preparation checks. Checked 10 October 2026.

[3] US Food and Drug Administration. Food Code 2026.

[Open the original source](#)

A model food code offered for jurisdictional adoption, not an automatically universal restaurant rule. Consult applicable current local requirements. Checked 10 October 2026.

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